THE



TORRENT



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INTRODUCTION

CHAPTER 00

THE NET'S ALIVE.

They'll tell you it's just Hardware; an endless sea of ones and zeros, amounting to just another tool for the corporations. You know better, Operator, that's why you're here, tossing your mind across the yawning void of space on radio waves and quantum relays to reach this shared hallucination. This is a place where dreams are made, and legends are born.

The Year is 2531. Three decades ago, the Second Corporate War ravaged Known Space. In its wake, a new era of espionage, crime lords, and space pirates began. At the center of this new wave is The Torrent, an underground pirate city in the consensual hallucination known as Cyberspace. Away from the prying eyes of the corporate data harvesting algorithms and sheltered from the rogue Viruses that stalk abandoned corners of the Net, The Torrent is a hive of criminals, pirates, and lowlives. But for many, it represents freedom and escape from a life dominated by the corporations.

You are an Operator, a human who pushes the limits of your mind to master Cyberspace. Your digitized consciousness can go where others can't. You see the world behind the scenes and operate outside the rules of the corporations. In this shared hallucination, you can make your dreams reality. Will you chase money? Power? Freedom? That's for you to decide, but what's certain is that The Torrent is dangerous. This world will not wait, adapt or disappear.

TABLETOP ROLE-PLAYING GAMES

Tabletop Role-Playing Games (TTRPGs) like The Torrent are typically played with groups of 4-6 players, with one player overseeing the other players' adventure, guiding them through a storyline either made by them or otherwise, presenting the other players with obstacles and challenges, and generally acting as in-game Non-Player Characters (NPCs). This player is called the Digital MasterMind (DMM). Other players should create their own player character to engage with the DMM's story, steps of which are found in Chapter 03.

The Torrent TTRPG, similar to other TTRPGs, is played with numerous dice of various side numbers, specifically multiple 6-sided dice (D6) and 12-sided dice (D12). You will overall need more D6s than D12s to play this game, and it is recommended that players each have their own supply of dice to facilitate this game's rolling systems.

Additionally, The Torrent TTRPG utilizes a hex-based grid in its combat mechanics, and it is recommended that either the DMM or any one of the other players provide a basic hex-based grid to facilitate combat.

How to Play

Games set in The Torrent are heavily based on heists and other clandestine missions called Gigs, and on the criminal connections players form while pulling them off. The player characters are referred to as Operators, working together in a Crew. Each Gig should be an opportunity for the DMM to build an overarching narrative by tying in the Operators' existing connections or introducing them to new characters or organizations that will come back later. For the players, a Gig should be an opportunity to leverage existing connections to their advanTage or form new ones to benefit them in the future.

An Example of Play

A Crew of four Operators, Peri, Barry, JustinTime, and Xx_WhippedCream_xX, have been hired to retrieve a specific data packet from an abandoned Datafortress. They were sent to speak with Nolan, a certain shady figure, to obtain the necessary security key. Arriving at the meeting spot in the outskirts of No-Man's Land, they approach a ramshackle building ridden with visual glitches.

DMM: "As you enter the room, you hear: (as Nolan) 'You must be the morons Kinshou hired.' Standing there across the room, you see his stark avatar, clean in a two-piece suit, contrasting with the drab feeling of the environment."

Barry: "Are you our contact?"

DMM (as Nolan): "I don't answer stupid questions. Your employer should have given you an identifier; show it to me."

Peri: "I don't like the look of this guy, *asking DMM* what can I make of him from here?"

DMM: "Go ahead and make an Insight roll."

Peri: Okay, so I've got 3 Ranks in Insight, so that's 3 Rank Die and an Action Die… *rolling* … alright, I got 15 total.

DMM: *rolled Nolan's Deceive – 4 Ranks allowed for a 17 total* "You aren't able to discern anything notable".

Peri (out of character) : "Damn!"

Xx_WhippedCream_xX: *Shows Kinshou's insignia* "Here, she gave us this."

DMM (as Nolan): *chuckles* "I guess she really is getting desperate."

JustinTime: "Jeez! Do you have the key or not!?"

DMM: "I'm not handing something this valuable over for free. I want… 100 Torrum."

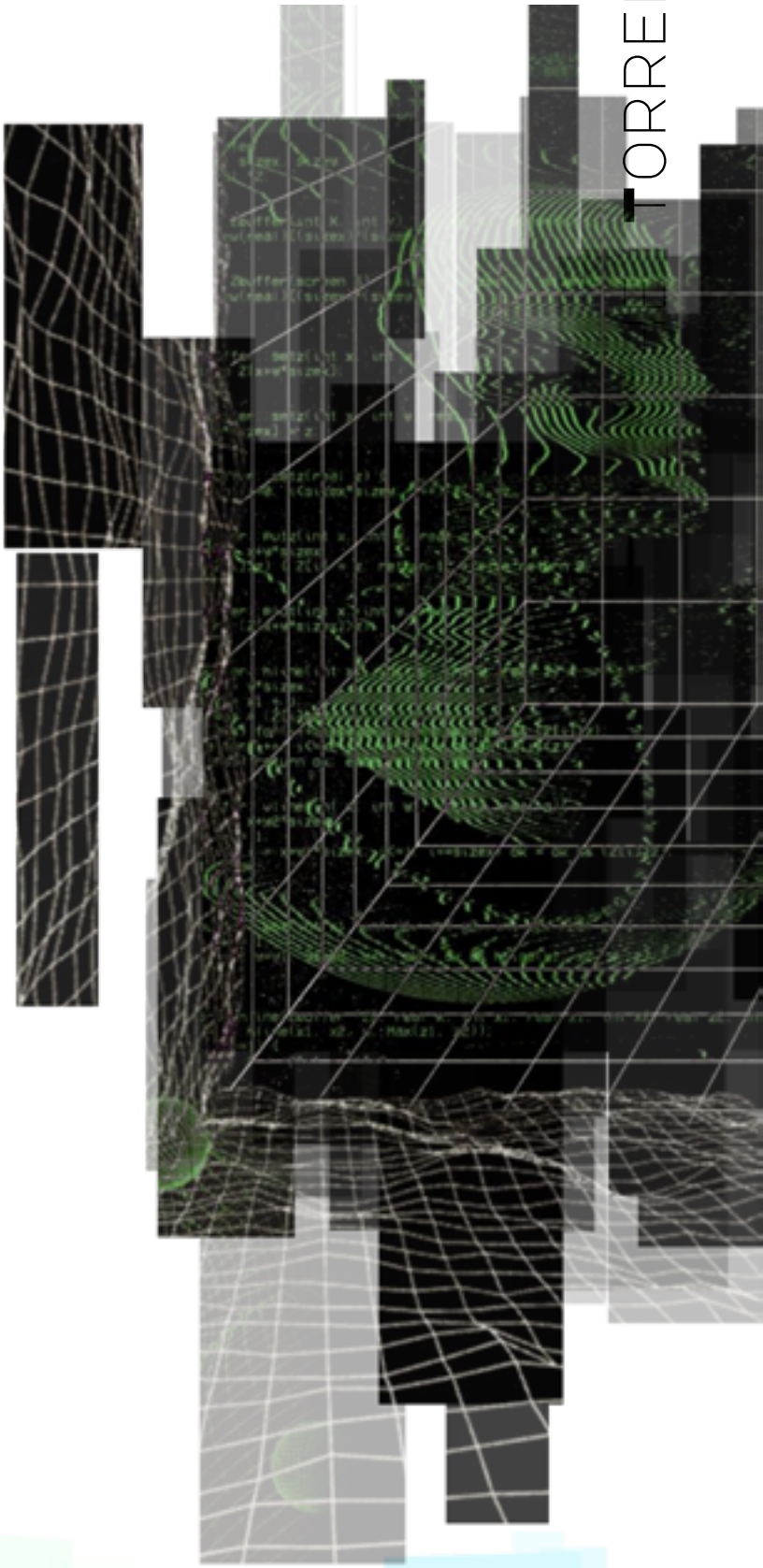
JustinTime: "Fair enough… here you go."

Stories in Cyberspace

The Torrent can accommodate a wide variety of stories, but thrives best when the story focuses on heist-style adventures and the criminal underworld of Cyberspace. What the story looks like can vary based on the type of story the DMM wants to tell. An example would be a trek into abandoned corners of the Net to retrieve lost corporate secrets. This kind of story would allow for puzzles, death-defying combat against monstrous rogue Viruses, and the exploration of vast digital complexes.

Alternatively, the story may stay inside The Torrent, with the players following a complex urban mystery. A story like this would offer a chance for intrigue, social maneuvering, and potentially combat with other Operators.

Both of these stories can exist side by side and even lead into one another seamlessly.



THE AGE OF TORRENTITE

CHAPTER 01



In the Year 2531, humanity spread far across the stars. The Board, the corporate rulers of known space, controls 13 star systems, 5 asteroid clusters, 11 planets, and 19 moons. Recognized colonies are established on all 11 planets and 7 of the moons. Including those unrecognized by the corporations, there are 57 total colonies, with 8 of them being centers of technology and corporate interests. The rest act as harvest colonies, extracting resources for the benefit of their far-off corporate owners.

Humanity, in its isolated settlements light-years apart from one another, is connected only by the Net. The Net, or the Interstellar Communication Network, is a faster-than-light communication network that spans the entirety of known space. Most people access the Net through the screens of home consoles or mobile devices, but beneath the surface, there is a hidden layer. Within the machines and servers that run humanity's digital infrastructure, exists a world all of its own, Cyberspace.

Cyberspace, as opposed to Realspace, is a shared dream; a hallucination conjured by the perpetually sleeping mind of an AI known as the Neural Upload Telecommunication Engine, or N.U.T.E. Humans across known space can enter this dream using implants that employ a process known as the Somatic Tele-Encephalography Method, or S.T.E.M., to upload their sleeping minds onto the Net. What one sees when entering Cyberspace can vary. The landscape is created by the human mind's attempt to interpret digital architecture as physical space. The interpretive nature of Cyberspace means that although its functionality and shape are the same to most people, almost everyone experiences it slightly differently.

Much of Cyberspace exists solely as a digital workplace for corporations where they can monitor every facet of their employees' productivity. However, there are those who operate outside the rules of the corporations. These pirate operators have their own underground network within Cyberspace. The Torrent is the center of this network. A gleaming hidden city on the Net away from corporate scrutiny, it is both a hive of criminal scum and a heartland of art and expression. Each person who visits leaves their mark, making the city itself a collage of the raw, unfiltered human condition.

Torrentites, Operators who work in The Torrent, say that only in The Torrent can one truly be free. Only there are they wholly themselves, unbound by laws, society, or biology. In this age, they say, autonomy is only afforded to those who leave polite society behind. This is the age of The Torrentite.

PART 1 :: HISTORY

2237 :: The Starward Expansion

In 2237, a coalition of Earth-based corporations known as Starpath Enterprises took it upon themselves to expand humanity across the stars. Motivated by the depleting resources on Earth and the tentative habitability of Mars, they sent out generation ships to seed nearby solar systems with new colonies.

With the ability to make their goal a reality, the deployment of generation ships began. Each generation ship was equipped with the resources necessary to construct a Hyperion Gate. With a Network of Hyperion Gates established, travel between star systems could be done in months, rather than decades.

In 2387, the invention of Quantum Entanglement Relays made instantaneous communication between humanity's distant colonies possible. With this revolution in communication, the settlements which had come to develop radically different cultures and systems of government eventually came to form a coalition known as the United Council of Sovereign Systems (UCSS). This interstellar government operated as a confederate republic, pushing for a decentralized rule of law and seeking to facilitate trade between the colonies.

2431 :: Cyberspace is Born

As Interstellar business became easier, and increasing amounts of work was performed over the Net, the system of connected Quantum Entanglement Relays, Roland Corporation, a subsidiary of Starpath Enterprises, began a

project to maximize digital productivity: N.U.T.E. (Neural Upload Telecommunication Engine). An Artificial Intelligence designed to be neutral and dormant, but operate as a hub for processing neural signals connected to the Net. Its Hardware, a near-perfect mechanical copy of the human brain, allowed users to connect their brains and experience the Net as if it were a physical world. This world became known as Cyberspace.

Cyberspace offered several advantages for corporations. For one, it allowed for instant communication between work locations with the same efficiency as sharing an office. However, the larger benefit was the acceleration of thought in Cyberspace, the ability to constantly monitor the biological and neurological functions of employees, and the elimination of breaks for biological requirements such as meals, sleep, and restroom breaks.

Soon after the birth of Cyberspace, people across known space began creating their own underground Cyberspace Domains. For some, these acted as social or recreational spaces outside the reach of corporate algorithm-driven social media. But many of these spaces were hubs of criminal and pirate activity on the Net. At first, the large corporations took little notice of these independent spaces, cracking down on them only when they directly threatened profits. It's believed The Torrent first emerged during this time, although the exact time of its conception is unknown.

2477 :: The First Corporate War

As corporations became more focused on interstellar expansion, they began to run into colonial regulations more and more frequently. This led to several skirmishes between corporate and colonial forces. Over several years, tensions rose and violence between the colonies and the corporations became more frequent. Many, especially pro-corporate talking heads, began to accuse the UCSS of being too weak to end the violence. In the end, as public opinion shifted, Starpath Enterprises stepped in to stop the conflict by threatening both the colonies and the corporations with the revocation of access to the Net and the Hyperion Gates.

With faith in the UCSS gone, and Starpath Enterprises in control, the conglomerate declared the establishment of a new interstellar government known as The Board. Soon after, the Board established a military presence in each of the colonies. Reliance on the Net and resources from the Hyperion Gates left the colonies with little hope for revolt, and the Board declared themselves the rulers of known space.

During the war, underground Domains were often used as staging grounds for colonial cyberattacks on corporate systems, as well as communication hubs for resistance movements. The Torrent especially hosted a large number of anti-corporate resistance fighters, and often acted as a hub between colonies in different regions of space coordinating strikes. After the colonies were defeated, corporations demanded tighter regulation of Cyberspace. Palantir Software, a subsidiary of Starpath Enterprises, was put in charge of monitoring Cyberspace and shutting down underground Domains. The Torrent was one of the few Domains to survive this time period due to its decentralized nature.

2497 :: The Second Corporate War

After it was established, the Board did little to regulate business, promising that free market economics would naturally lead to an efficient and prosperous society. However, the lack of oversight led smaller corporations to begin skirmishes over territory and resources. As this grew into a full-scale conflict, it became known as the Second Corporate War.

By this time, a large amount of corporate infrastructure had been moved onto the Net. Soon after the war began, Cyberspace had become one of the major theaters of the conflict. Large portions of the Net were subject to direct conflict between corporate Operators. Contracted bands of privateer Operators harassed Net traffic, bringing communication to a standstill in many star systems.

The most devastating attacks came in the form of malicious learning algorithms known as Viruses. The first Viruses were developed by Roland Corporation, intended to infiltrate Net infrastructure and multiply until they overwhelmed the Hardware's processing power. However, over the course of the war more and more destructive Viruses were developed and deployed across Cyberspace, causing severe Damage to both the Net and the Operators who use it.

After Starpath Enterprises started to see record profit losses around 2503, the Board sent forces from Rogue & Swat to quell the violence. Once the corporations were brought into line, ongoing cyberattacks were terminated. Following this conflict, the Board began to regulate inter-corporate conflict through its courts.

The Net was left deeply scarred by this conflict. Many of the Viruses released onto the Net couldn't be accounted for or contacted after the fighting ended, so large regions of the Net became dangerous hotspots for the rogue algorithms. The corporations deemed that eliminating the Viruses or disposing of the ruined infrastructure would be far more expensive than developing better firewalls to protect their remaining Domains, so these "Dead Domains" were left to

rot, neither deactivated nor in use.

2505 :: The Media Purge

After the end of the Second Corporate War, people were outraged at the corporations. Many saw this war as a sign that the Board viewed its citizens as disposable tools. This rising anti-corporate sentiment led to widespread rioting and protesting in several colonies. The Board responded by quickly stepping in to suppress the masses with forces from Rouge & Swat. After these events, the Board initiated what's now referred to as the Media Purge of 2505 or just the '05 Purge.

During this event, the Board seized control of news and entertainment media across known space, declaring that an anti-corporate propaganda agenda in the media had led to the violence. During this purge, the Board erased much of humanity's media from the Net, leaving only what media they deemed to be "free of anti-corporate bias," and heavily scrutinized any new media being produced. Because of this, The Torrent became one of the only places left where you can find lost media from before the Turn of the century.

2515 :: The Great Incursion

The Second Corporate War saw The Torrent grow exponentially. It was hit with Virus incursions early on in the Second Corporate war, but by the end of the war, Torrentites had developed relatively robust firewalls to protect themselves.

The rise of privateer hacker groups and increased corporate involvement in the underground Net meant there was a lot of money in becoming an Operator in The Torrent. Not everyone was happy with this shift, many saw it as a corruption of The Torrent's free and independent foundations. Regardless, there's no denying that The Torrent exploded in size and popularity. The war made The Torrent a household name. In the present day even those who have never been there have heard of it.

However, after the end of the conflict, the appearance of Viruses in The Torrent became increasingly common. Because of The Torrent's peer-to-peer infrastructure, it was uniquely susceptible to incursions from individual connected devices. The more visitors The Torrent saw, the more susceptible it became.

In late 2525, The Torrent would experience the largest incursion to date. Whether it was a directed attack or an accidental breach is unknown, but during the incursion, tens of thousands of Viruses poured directly into The Torrent. A particularly large and monstrous Virus, affectionately nicknamed Goji, spearheaded the incursion. While Torrentite Operators would eventually eliminate the Virus threat, The Torrent was permanently corrupted in places that saw the most Virus activity. These dead areas of The Torrent became known as No-Man's Land.

After the Great Incursion, gangs and organizations across The Torrent agreed that they needed to have an organized response to Viruses. In addition to distributing sophisticated firewall Software to visitors of The Torrent, an organization known as the Flyswatters was founded to handle Viruses found within the city.

2522 :: The Phobos Heist

Seeking to undermine corporate influence in The Torrent, a Torrentite punk band known as Cosmic Noise staged a heist on Roland Corporation's most secure Datafortress. The Phobos Datafortress is the hub of the N.U.T.E. AI that runs the underlying infrastructure of Cyberspace. Cosmic Noise infiltrated this Datafortress and stole a N.U.T.E. control key, giving them administrative permissions over the underlying architecture of Cyberspace.



This heist became a massive cultural moment for The Torrent. Anti-corporate sentiment only continued to rise after the Second Corporate War, especially in The Torrent where corporations were increasingly inserting themselves into underground dealings. The heist made the band heroes in the eyes of Torrentites, and radical terrorists in the eyes of the Board.

Once they obtained the control key, Cosmic Noise used it to directly influence The Torrent's underlying architecture, creating the Circle, a central neutral territory for The Torrent's various gangs and organizations to converse. With this newfound power, the gangs of The Torrent were able to push out corporate infiltrators, and negotiate their own terms for the governing of the pirate city.

2531 :: Current Day

In the three decades since The Second Corporate War, the interstellar community has experienced a period of relative peace. However, during this time, the Board has become increasingly aggressive in its efforts to root out anti-corporate sentiment, reigniting old tensions and pushing more people into a life of crime both in the real world and in The Torrent.

The current day is also seeing a resurgence of art, especially in The Torrent and other places outside of corporate influence. The Board's increasing aggression in its suppression of media and culture is backfiring and contributing to the formation of a growing underground punk movement.

The punk movement itself is experiencing a major schism. Within The Torrent, many have Turned against Cosmic Noise. What started as an initiative to free The Torrent from corporate influence has, in the eyes of many, become a centralized government with the former punk band as the head. Many members have left the band on this principle, and Torrentites in general have soured on their once heroes. Cosmic Noise itself asserts that its only interest is the protection of The Torrent from corporate influences.

In recent years, increasing numbers of people have reported strange things happening across Cyberspace, especially in The Torrent. Some claim to encounter what have been nicknamed "Echoes", avatars that look and behave uncannily like themselves, appearing briefly before vanishing without explanation. Others describe sudden, rapid shifts in Cyberspace architecture: corridors rearranging themselves, walls manifesting or disappearing, or entire buildings flickering into different colors and materials. A smaller number report hearing faint, indecipherable voices, even when they claim to have been alone. All manner of superstitions have sprung up around these rumors, but most believe them to be mass delusions induced by prolonged exposure to Cyberspace. Although some fear that these are symptoms of a slow breakdown of the Net itself.

PART 2 :: THE TORRENT

To one used to the single-purpose utilitarian Cyberspaces run by the corporations The Torrent would be a truly alien landscape. It's a chaotic collage of color, sound, and motion. Each unique user in The Torrent can add their own touch and affect the landscape using Tags. Over time, this has resulted in a hodgepodge city skyline reminiscent of a bustling market or a crowded shanty town.

Unlike typical Cyberspace, The Torrent is functionally infinite. Despite this, there are a limited number of entry points to The Torrent from corporate Cyberspace as a precaution against Palantir's data-harvesting algorithms. These entry points shift from time to time, but there are set places they often return to. These places have become hubs of activity in The Torrent, with many Tags set up right outside the entrances to advertise their services to those entering The Torrent. Because entry points to The Torrent correspond to a user's position in real-space, many of the areas surrounding these entrances have developed strong cultural identities tied to real-space colonies.

Tags

Tags are The Torrent's way of delineating ownership of space in the digital world. When a person in The Torrent Tags a space, they become able to manipulate it in various ways. Torrentites use Tags to establish signs, storefronts, and other buildings. However, there are many other uses for Tags. Any physical object or structure you can imagine would most likely need a Tag to exist on The Torrent.

Tags work by marking a certain area of The Torrent to be influenced by the user. Users can influence this space in various ways, and the most effective methods tend to vary depending on the person. Some people design spaces with a thought, others use code to define geometry, and some can create and manipulate various materials within their Tag to construct new things. Regardless of what methods one uses, a Tag is one's own space to do with as they will. '

There is no real limit to the amount of Tagged space a user can control in The Torrent. However, Tag influence is sent from one's device to The Torrent's network. As a result, the amount of space and the number of Tags a user can control are tied to their system's storage and computing power. Thus, users with better hardware or more optimized software can influence more space in The Torrent.

Tagged space is not inviolable. Unless special software is used to restrict access, Tags do not prevent other users from

entering. Additionally, any user can place a Tag anywhere in The Torrent, even if that space has already been Tagged. As a result, Torrentites often fiercely fight over territory, and gang affiliation is frequently a requirement for protecting one's Tags from being overwritten or vandalized. There is fierce competition over prime spots in high-traffic areas of The Torrent, so making connections is crucial for any Torrentite who wants to be taken seriously.

Some Tags can be programmed to have specialized purposes. For example, Tagstriders, a type of specialized mobile Tag, are a commo enough sight in The Torrent. Logsafes are another kind of modified Tag on The Torrent that allows users to easily log in and out of The Torrent without needing to use one of The Torrent's many entry points. However, modifying Tags in this way can be quite difficult and requires esoteric knowledge of The Torrent's inner workings, so not many can do this on their own. Instead, Torrentites often purchase pre- modified Tags or helper software for performing these modifications themselves.



Shin-Akihabara

Shin-Akihabara is an area in the eastern region of The Torrent that has become a major hub for pirated games, movies, anime, books, and other media. Shin-Akihabara exploded in popularity after the Media Purge of '05, as it's one of the few remaining places in all of human civilization where people can freely experience lost media. Aside from entertainment, Shin-Akihabara is also one of the premier places to obtain black-market Software. Many first-timers to The Torrent will head here first to make sure they're properly hidden from Palantir's data harvesting algorithms.

The architecture of Shin-Akihabara is one of the greatest sights to behold in The Torrent. Hundreds of thousands of Tags stack atop one another in layers, stretching up like skyscrapers. All manner of sky bridges, walkways, and floating platforms span between the stacks and criss-cross above the streets. The blazing neon lights wash the dark streets and alleys with color. In the center of the district is the Atrium, a vast open space where the bridges and walkways part to allow Torrentites to see the Tags stretch on into the sky. Few can claim to have walked through this district unmoved by the sight.

Shin-Akihabara derives its name from Akihabara in Tokyo, Japan, a place with a similar reputation for technology and media during the 21st century. The Torrent entry points around Shin-Akihabara are most often accessed by users connecting to the Net from colonies in the Itokawasei star system. These colonists are originally of Japanese descent, and although their culture has undergone significant changes in the centuries since they left Earth, the influence of these colonists is what gives Shin-Akihabara its distinctly Japanese cultural identity.

Shin-Akihabara is one of the few places in The Torrent where one could set up a Tag without explicit backing from a gang. Agreements between individual Tag owners keep the streets orderly and free of territorial disputes. Shin-Akihabara also has one of the most efficient transportation networks in The Torrent, with several groups working together to maintain a complex system of rails, roads, walkways, and bridges that grant access to the densely packed and layered Tags all across the district.

Shin-Akihabara's apparent lack of major gangs has led some to whisper conspiracy theories of a shadowy Yakuza that puppeteers the district behind closed doors. All of the major Tag owners in the district will claim these rumors are unfounded. After all, what would such an organization hide from The Torrent of all places? All the same, rumors and conspiracies spread, and other Torrentites tend to treat Shin-Akihabara with suspicion.

Centauri Street

Centauri Street is an area in the western region of The Torrent known for its many gangs, crime families, and pirate groups. Some of The Torrent's most powerful groups operate out of Centauri Street. Most commonly, Centauri Street gangs will act as muscle to settle territorial disputes or as hiring agencies for assassins. Also common on Centauri Street are casinos and drug dens where addicts can find their next fix.

From certain angles, Centauri Street might look like an ordinary residential area you might find in a Realspace city, albeit with much more verticality. The lights here are dim and warm-toned, washing the region in a calming sepia, and Tags aren't densely stacked. The Tags here resemble apartments, single-family homes, or even small mansions. Centauri Street can be shady, gaudy, and anywhere in between. The streets here are deadly quiet, save for the muffled sound of music and rowdy partying coming from within a casino or bar. One would be forgiven for mistaking Centauri Street for an understated, comfortable corner of The Torrent. However, this couldn't be further from the truth, as behind the closed doors of those residential buildings are gangs ready to tear each other apart at the drop of a hat. Beneath the quiet air is a raging cold war between deadly crime syndicates vying for power and territory all across The Torrent.

People from Centauri Street rarely agree on anything, and this includes the name. Gang wars have been fought over what one decides to call this place. Centauri Street is the most common, but many also call it Centauri Avenue, Centauri Row, Centauri Drive, and so on. Using the wrong term with the wrong people can easily lead to a brawl. Outsiders looking in often joke that the Centauri Street gangs must just be looking for reasons to fight.

However, the fractious nature of the residents of Centauri Street comes from its namesake, the Alpha Centauri Colonies. Being the closest colonies to Earth, Alpha Centauri was a popular choice for people and organizations all across the globe. Eventually, the colony was bogged down by so many conflicting interests that it just exploded. The early days of Alpha Centauri were marked by an all-out brawl involving hundreds of colonists and spanning several days. Alcohol was involved. Eventually, everyone got so tired of fighting that they all put their fists down and went home. Random fights and arguments would continue to be common on Alpha Centauri after that. However, over the centuries since the colonists left Earth, they formed a strange united culture around never agreeing with one another. Dying on your own personal hill became a national pastime. Since The Torrent entry points around Centauri Street all lead to Alpha Centauri, this corner of The Torrent adopted that particular cultural quirk.

No-Man's Land

No-Man's Land is an area in the northern region of The Torrent that was Damaged during The Great Incursion. The Viruses that poured in during that time corrupted this area to such an extent that Tags no longer function within it. Because of this, very few Torrentites ever visit this land, and it has garnered a cursed reputation among even the most skeptical residents of The Torrent. All manner of superstition and 'creepypasta' surround this place. Some claim the souls of those who died on the day of the Great Incursion still linger in the ruins or that the ruins themselves are alive and waiting to gobble up intruders. Others fear that the Viruses were never truly eradicated, and lie in wait for a chance to strike.

When one gets to see a birds-eye-view of The Torrent, they'll see glimmering city lights that stretch on into the distance for miles. One would see the shining neon of Shin-Akihabara, the bustling vehicle lights all around The Circle, and the gaudy flashing signs of The Lucky-66. But none of these would stand out more than No-Man's Land. Many describe it like a blackened scar against the shining backdrop of The Torrent, a lone pool of infinite darkness amongst the glittering lights. A view of No-Man's Land from the air never fails to spark dread in the hearts of Torrentites who see it.

The view is even worse on the ground. All that remains of the bustling Chinatown that once stood here are twisted ruins and corrupted Tags. Rubbled buildings and crushed roads are a common sight, but stranger things can be found here. In some places, the buildings and the very landscape seem warped and twisted in ways that don't physically make sense. In addition, the corrupted geography of No-Man's Land can be extremely dangerous. Floors may lack collision, or invisible objects may block your path. Fundamental assumptions about physics and gravity will begin to fail you the further in you travel. However, any Torrentite crazy enough to venture

in will tell you that the worst part about No-Man's Land is the silence. No sound at all travels in the deep parts of No-Man's Land, leaving any foolish enough to venture deep within without the ability to hear their own footsteps or even cry for help.

The Lucky-66 Strip

The Lucky-66 Strip is a small area in the northwest region of The Torrent known for its many casinos, games, events, and other forms of entertainment. Considered the party capital of The Torrent, The Lucky-66 is a popular gathering spot for regular Torrentites and passing visitors alike. While this area is most famous for gambling, having the highest concentration of casinos anywhere in The Torrent, there are many other fun competitions like racing, dance-offs, and even fighting. Of course, betting is common in these events as well.

The Lucky-66 Strip is a gaudy sea of golden-trimmed buildings and flashing, lit-up signs. The place beams so intensely that many Torrentites consider it to be an eyestore. The streets hum constantly with the sounds of loud music and partying, with the occasional crash from a fight breaking out. The Tags here are primarily large single-purpose structures decorated to draw the eye in every way possible.

The huge Tags in The Lucky-66 are thanks to the whole area being controlled by just a handful of powerful gangs and pirate groups. These large groups work hard to maintain the massive amounts of space they've claimed on The Lucky-66 Strip, and will vigorously drive out anyone who sets up shop without permission.

While some casinos in The Lucky-66 can wire Torrum through shell companies to pay out winnings, Torrum isn't the most commonly gambled commodity. It's common for Torrentites to bet things like assets, Tag locations, data packets, and oftware. However, by far the most commonly gambled currency is favors. On The Torrent, your connections are everything. Being owed a favor by a major gang or a well-known Torrentite could be the difference between making a name for yourself or fading into obscurity. For the gangs that own the casinos, pulling in favors from people all across The Torrent makes defending territory and gathering large amounts of information much easier. And while it's not uncommon for Torrentites to try to dodge the responsibility when their favors are called in, those who attempt this may find Tags all across The Torrent shut their doors in their face.

The Circle

The Torrent's main commercial hub, The Circle lies in the center of The Torrent, lined with all manner of small individuals' shops and corporations' storefronts. The Circle's architecture and street art is a symbol of its permanence, as an old part of The Torrent, its code hasn't been able to be copied. It is a beacon of stability amongst an ever changing world.

The Thunderdome

The Thunderdome is a massive flying sports stadium that travels around The Torrent, hosting various big-ticket sports events and competitions. Although a variety of sports, both traditional and novel, are played in the Thunderdome's various facilities, by far the most popular events are the fights. Rooted in the traditions of pro-wrestling, martial arts, and ancient gladiatorial combat, these fights are truly spectacles to behold. Often, combatants can choose between several different types of Hyperstim weapons, including projectile variants, which send intense stimuli through their opponent's S.T.E.M. cables to overwhelm their nervous system. Fights usually continue until one of the contestants concedes the fight or is no longer able to move.

The Thunderdome derives its name from its iconic floating base, resembling a swirling storm cloud. Atop the cloud is a huge facility that looks like a cross between the Roman Colosseum and the old Beira-Rio Stadium back on Earth. The massive stadium features several smaller offshoot facilities for various sports, which are arranged radially around the large central arena. The stadium itself can also be configured to accommodate several different sports. There's even a small WSPY facility where the events are broadcast across The Torrent and beyond. Between the large stadium and the smaller courts, at any given time, there's guaranteed to be at least one event going on in the Thunderdome.

Because one's abilities in Cyberspace are largely dependent on one's S.T.E.M. equipment and Hardware, the setups allowed for certain sports are highly standardized in The Torrent, and contestants' system specs are always checked before they are allowed to compete. Different leagues have different equipment and software restrictions or requirements. However, many Torrentites criticize this standardized system, as it often makes Cybersports difficult for those with less means. As a result, numerous groups throughout The Torrent host unregulated competitions and events.

The organization that runs the Thunderdome calls itself the Sky-Kings, or the Kings for short. The Kings have no system of hierarchy within their organization, considering each member to be a "king" in their own right, regardless of status or gender. The only seniority in the group comes from experience.

Outwardly, the Kings are rather tame by the standards of The Torrent, not publicly involving themselves in gang politics or large-scale criminal activities. However, aside from their public association with Cosmic Noise and WSPY, there are whispers of darker connections at play. Some Torrentites claim that the only way they could manage such large events

and such a huge Tag is with the help of powerful Torrent gangs. Others accuse the Kings of being in league with, or even operated by, a wealthy Board-sanctioned corporation.

The Bug Jar

The Bug Jar is the largest concert venue on The Torrent. Members of both Cosmic Noise and The Bristles perform weekly shows that are open to anyone on The Torrent. WSPY also has its own monitoring setup in The Bug Jar, allowing performances to be seen all across The Torrent.

The Bug Jar is one of the main hangout spots for members of Cosmic Noise. Whenever there isn't an event, members of Cosmic Noise treat it as a practice space for writing new music. At almost any time, loud rock music can be heard blaring from The Bug Jar when walking by it. While it is technically open to the public at all times, it's rare to see people unaffiliated with Cosmic Noise perform there. Despite this, the venue does occasionally hold an Open Mic event.

When Cosmic Noise was planning their heist of the N.U.T.E. Control Key, The Bug Jar served as their base of operations and planning. Back then, the Bug Jar was not a public space and was considered a dangerous part of The Torrent that had been Damaged by Viruses during the corporate wars. It's an open secret that WSPY's monitoring setup in The Bug Jar was originally created to help get Cosmic Noise into the Phobos Datafortress. However, members of Cosmic Noise still refuse to comment when asked about this theory.

WSPY Station

WSPY Station is the face of the WSPY Pirates, as well as their base of operations. WSPY Station serves as a kind of radio station in The Torrent and is located in The Circle. People in The Torrent can tune into the station with WSPY's custom Software and listen to any music or DJ shows they broadcast.

WSPY Station has a public lounge and radio bar, where people can talk with WSPY members at the front desk, make song requests, join WSPY, or just hang out. The production studios are limited to approved members of WSPY. These include three broadcast rooms: one for officially aired content, and the other two are private studios that only broadcast internally to the WSPY Station. Finally, there is an executive complex, where only WSPY higher-ups have access. WSPY Station is one of the most noticeable Tags in The Circle on account of the giant spinning cannon on the top of it, an homage to the WSPY pirates' high seas branding.

On top of broadcasting music and news, WSPY Station is also one of The Torrent's largest databases. Not only does it archive all of its broadcasts, but it also stores some of the most complex signal injection software on the Net. Because of this, WSPY Station's executive complex is one of the most secure locations in The Torrent. While data theft is common enough in The Torrent, none have yet managed to breach the secured vaults of WSPY Station.

X3 Tacowo

X3 Tacowo is an elusive taco truck that sells all manner of rare weapons and dangerous Software, as well as some of the best virtual food in The Torrent. The truck itself is loud and usually causes chaos when it pops up. Despite this, no one has been able to track down where it goes when it leaves. To all outside observers, the thing just seems to vanish after tearing up the town.

The taco truck is run by an eccentric gang of Torrentites who all have avatars resembling an early 21st-century music icon known as "Hatsune Miku." It's unclear if this is a gimmick or some kind of cult, as the Mikus don't tend to interact with others except to scream misquoted song lyrics at them and sell tacos and weapons. X3 Tacowo only accepts Mikoins, which are strange tokens that sometimes appear in The Torrent. No one knows where the tokens come from, with the prevailing theory being that the Mikus drop them in random locations as part of some kind of game or ritual.

Regardless of the taco truck's eccentricities, their Software is no joke. Some of the most deadly weapons ever released into the digital world have moved through the arms dealer on wheels.

PART 3 :: ARCHITECTURE OF THE NET

The digital world is made up of two parts, Netspace and the Domains. Domains are websites brought to life, intentionally designed spaces that exist within dedicated servers. The Space in between Domains is known as Netspace. Netspace represents the connective infrastructure of the net, the wires, radio signals, and Quantum Entanglement Relays that allow signals to travel across known space.

The Torrent is just one of these Domains, although it is very different from most. Most domains are nothing more than virtual workspaces for corporations. They're designed to monitor employees while keeping them in a controlled environment where maximum productivity is enforced. Alternatively, because Cyberspace is less accessible to the public, corporations often use secure Domains known as Datafortresses to store their sensitive data. Datafortresses are also used as workspaces when a private development environment is necessary.

Other Domains are closer to what you would expect from a website, like a forum or online shopping site made into a 3D space. Many of these Cyberspace Domains are simply extensions of websites designed for desktop and mobile devices, meaning their layout in Cyberspace is often highly inconvenient and given little thought. However, the Corporate Net is not completely devoid of curated Cyberspace experiences. Virtual theaters are popular with streaming services, offering personal, premium movie viewing experiences. Museums and Libraries often provide virtual tours and reading rooms. MMOs used to be popular in cyberspace, but following the media purge of 2505, many of them were forced to shut down.

The Net relies on Quantum Entanglement Relays to communicate between star systems. Because of this, each relay serves its own isolated region. Net traffic to Domains in other regions requires Operators to move through the Relays, which also act as secure checkpoints for Palantir's digital surveillance state. The Torrent's peer-to-peer architecture allows it to circumvent the typical restrictions imposed by the Net's segmented regions. The Torrent has hidden connections to domains all across cyberspace, meaning it is often used as a way to circumvent surveillance on the Net.

There are 13 regions of the Net corresponding to the 13 inhabited star systems. The regions communicate with each other in a loop, with each Relay connecting to two others, allowing signals to travel around the loop to any other region. Because of its layout, the Relay's Cyberspace architecture resembles a rail network. Some regions have subregions that communicate with each other. These subregions are necessary only in star systems where there are colonies on multiple planets, such as the Sol system, necessitating additional Quantum Entanglement Relays to bridge the interplanetary gap.

The Sol Region

The Sol Region is the oldest region of the Net. It has 3 subregions, the Martian Sector, the Terran Sector, and the Jovian Sector, which serve humanity's 3 most populous colonies. The Interstellar Communication Network was an invention of students from the University of Ares on Mars. Because of this and Mars' high corporate presence, the Martian Sector is one of the largest regions of cyberspace, with the Terran sector coming in close second.

The Martian Sector

Domains in the Martian sector mainly serve as bases of operation for the most powerful corporations in known space, including Starpath Enterprises and its subsidiaries. Some of the most secure Datafortresses on the Net are in this sector, including the Phobos Datafortress, where the N.U.T.E. AI is housed. Despite the high corporate presence, the sheer number of domains in the Martian Sector means that some underground Domains are able to slip through the cracks here, making it the biggest region for cybercrime outside the Torrent.

The Terran Sector

The Terran Sector is home to the Crypt. Earth's old internet was phased out around the time that the Interstellar Communication Network began construction. Much of the websites there were incompatible with the new Net infrastructure, and so this artifact of humanity's first communication age was cordoned off from the rest of the Net in a single Domain known as the Crypt. Because of how different the Old Net is from the rest of Cyberspace, it is difficult to monitor, making it a hotspot for underground activity.

The rest of the Domains in the Terran sector are mostly trade platforms used by companies exporting resources from Earth to colonies across known space. The notable exception being a domain run by the Interstellar Institute for Biological Research called "The Net Alive". This Domain serves as a digital zoo and helps raise money for the institute's research projects. However, a popular conspiracy theory states that the digital animals are a front to test complex AI for the development of Viruses and other digital weapons.

The Jovian Sector

The Jovian Sector is much smaller than the others in the Sol Region, and mostly dedicated to research and data collection. The colonies and outposts dotted across Jupiter's moons primarily serve scientific institutions, with the second largest focus being on the extraction of Hydrogen fuel from Jupiter itself. Domains of note here include one of the Net's largest open libraries and some smaller Datafortresses housing sensitive research. The Jovian Library has come under attack by the Board's censors many times throughout its history, but especially in the three decades following

The Centauri Region

The colonies in the Alpha Centauri star system primarily serve as a logistics hub, coordinating commercial shipments between other colonies across known space. The Proxima Corporation, humanity's premier shipping company, owns these colonies and this region of the Net.

Other than the Domains used for shipping by the Proxima Corporation, this region of Cyberspace is famous for the Extraterra Entertainment Domain, home of the most influential media company in known space. Extraterra Entertainment produces TV and news streamable from any of humanity's settlements across the stars. Its Domain is one

of the most popular places in Cyberspace for virtual theaters.

Yorgin Fighters Live is closely tied to Extraterra Entertainment. They're the most popular platform for pro wrestling and martial arts in known space. Their Domain includes digital stadiums where visitors can watch 3D recreations of fights, and even virtual fighting environments where visitors can test their virtual mettle against the wrestling scene's greatest stars.

Extraterra Entertainment maintains the Hydrogenkin Data Fortress. This fortress is where the media company stores its vast collection of data about Net users and current events that it uses to curate the content it produces.

The Laasa Region

The Laasa star system's primary industries are investments and medical research. This region's most popular Domains are Western's Luck Investments, which serves the financial interests of corporations in humanity's most distant colonies, and Qingshui Bioinformatics, the number one medical research corporation.

Western's Luck Investments maintains a Domain that gives clients 24/7 access to their financial advisors, as well as providing traders with live updates on the interstellar stock market. Western's owns the Deep West Data Fortress, which stores one of the most comprehensive stockpiles of financial data on the Net.

Qingshui Bioinformatics' Domain allows visitors to consult real medical professionals across Known Space, as well as acting as a forum for medical researchers. Their services allow their clients to shop for health coverage packages, and they offer cheap coverage for anyone willing to participate in experimental medical research programs. Qingshui owns the Qi-Bo Data Fortress, where terabytes of sensitive medical information, as well as secret cutting-edge medical projects, are stored.

Itakawasei Region

The Itakawasei star system is home to one of the few natural garden worlds humanity has discovered. Its vast oceans are home to millions of unique aquatic species. Naturally, this colony has a flourishing fishing industry. Sushi Tabehoudai and Kotoshiro Gyogyou lead this industry, sporting domains where users can peruse local dishes with simulated flavor, and view virtual recreations of the garden world's strange aquatic lifeforms.

M.T. Staff, a conglomerate of animation studios that have operated since the 20th century, recently moved its headquarters to this star system to avoid the Martian Animators' Union. They've recently come under fire by the board for publishing media containing anti-corporate themes, so much of their Domain has been scrubbed from the Net.

Takakura Keibi is a private security company that rents private armies to corporations in humanity's most distant colonies. Their domain acts mostly as an advertisement storefront for their services, with a simulated "war room" that gives live updates on crime statistics across Known Space. Takakura operates the Ken Data Fortress, where they compile surveillance data and sensitive information for their clients.

The Lacaille Region

The Lacaille Region is home to a large software development industry, with many domains in this region belonging to AI or Cyberspace startups. The most popular domains here belong to Vida Automatizada Development and Galaxito Games.

Vida Automatizada fashions its Domain as a playground for its autonomous AI agents, allowing them to roam freely and interact with users. Galaxito Games is the largest games developer in Known Space, and their Domain acts as a platform for purchasing and sharing games. Some areas of their domain are even used for Cyberspace MMOs. Galaxito Games was forced to remove a large amount of content from its store following the media purge of 2505, which means the Domain looks unusually empty for a digital storefront.

The Tau Seti Region

The Tau Seti star system is known for heavy industry and mining, being home to powerful companies like Freeman Molds and Vesuvius and Co. Mineral Extraction. Domains in this distant region are few and far between, with almost all of them having something to do with the sale or transportation of minerals.

The legendary Steve's Angels Mining Company calls this star system home. The pirate fleet turned deep-space mining company is renowned throughout Known Space for its rogue antics and underhanded tactics. Most of their Domain is a private, invite-only room for making trade deals or non-aggression agreements. Steve's Angels operates their own Datafortress, where they keep records of their more clandestine dealings as well as a treasure trove of data on the material makeup of asteroids surrounding the Tau Seti system and other star systems.

The WD Losa Region

Despite being a remote colony, the WD Losa star system prides itself on being an exporter of culture. Their main industries are fashion and gourmet food. Its top two companies, Hranger's Apparel and Kheflan Deluxe Desserts, run their own Domains with immersive experiences meant to

give visitors the "full experience of Tau Seti".

The Archus Region

The Archus star system is the headquarters of Harden Industries, a military contractor that focuses on developing deep-space weaponry and vehicle combat systems. The colony here is extremely small, so most of the Domains in this region are affiliated with Harden Industries. The Deslir Datafortress stores Harden's private research documentation.

The Gliese Region

The Gliese Region is one of the largest exporters of food in Known Space. The major corporations in the area, Green Gardens Greenhouses, Zeus Hardened Energy, and Samaran Sustenance, have established a 3-way trade agreement to maximise profits and crop production in their colonies. Because of their close partnership, the triad shares the same Domain, which, among other things, provides information to new franchisees on how to open a Green Gardens franchise farm.

Other domains in this region tend to be networking platforms for farm owners. These forums and social platforms have a reputation for rebellious behavior, as they often quickly result in attempts to form unions. The Triad has historically struggled to regulate these rogue Domains.

The Toiles Region

The Toiles System is a penal colony that primarily exports ores and labor. Mardu Co. is a major private prison corporation that operates out of this area. They rent out workers from their prison labor force to corporations all across Known Space. Their best customer is Oregon Ores, a local mining company.

Information in this region of the Net is tightly controlled. The only Domains in this area are operated directly by the corporations. Mardu's Domain is a labor matching website that allows corporations to shop for custom labor forces to suit their needs. Rumor has it that Mardu has a secret Datafortress where they store prisoner information and private channels that allow them to shop for prisoners across Known Space.

The Aoeol Region

The Aoeol star system was a relatively unknown colony until the release of Krion Online. Designed by Truant Digital, it's the first Cyberspace MMORPG to be released since the media purge of 2505. It faced significant pushback from Board censors, but eventually managed to push out an approval.

Most of the other Domains around the MMO focus on capitalizing on this unique kind of digital tourism. Many of these Domains serve as community forums or third-party trade platforms for in-game items. The citizens of the Aoeol colonies have expressed dissatisfaction with the flood of game-themed Domains drowning out the rest of their local Net, as well as the kinds of people that frequent the game.

The Ceres Region

The Ceres region is something of a corporate hub for the smaller corporations operating in humanity's most distant colonies. There are a lot of corporate workspace Domains in this region, mostly hosted by Urtuna's Finest Digital Spaces.

The other major corporations in the Ceres star system are Triage Co. and Rengeir Inc. Triage Co. provides emergency response to those suffering Cyberspace-related injuries and exports medical supplies. Their Domain includes cutting-edge



software to help Cyberspace Operators deal with the effects of Destabilization. Rengeir Inc. is a surveillance company that specializes in collecting data from cameras to build a complex model of the patterns and behaviors of all the people in a colony.

PART 4 :: IMPORTANT FIGURES

Cosmic Noise

Cosmic Noise is the most notorious gang in The Torrent. The punk band turned terrorist cell exists for the stated purpose of pushing corporate interests out of the Torrent. Originally, this group was just made up of people who enjoyed making noise. In their early years, they had a habit of playing pranks on corporations by blasting their music through their hijacked audio software. Cosmic Noise later went on to execute the most infamous heist in history, during which they broke into the Phobos Datafortress, and stole a N.U.T.E. Control Key.

This control key allowed Cosmic Noise to exert direct control over the fabric of the Net. With this power, they were able to establish the Circle, a neutral ground for negotiations that cannot be tagged. Cosmic Noise became mediators for talks between the largest powers on the Torrent, and coordinates with them to keep corporations out of their territory. However, their advisory status has been called into question lately as they have begun using the N.U.T.E. Control Key to enforce rules across the Torrent. Many accuse them of trying to become a governing body for the city, and several band members have left, claiming the band forgot what it means to be punk.

Cosmic Noise has a close relationship with the WSPY Pirates, who helped them during the Phobos Heist. The band often broadcasts performances through WSPY's services and shares venues with the pirates whenever it's convenient. However, rumor has it that this close relationship has become strained as of late, likely due to the band's quickly plummeting popularity.

WSPY

WSPY is a group of pirates that broadcast music and news. They arose shortly after the media purge of 2505, offering news, music, and other media that had been suppressed by the Board. WSPY's call letters stand for "West of the Mississippi Space Pirates Yarrr!", which is apparently some kind of inside joke that WSPY members refuse to explain.

WSPY is one of the most powerful groups on the torrent, having survived the city's ever-changing political landscape since the second corporate war. Besides broadcasting, the members of WSPY are involved in the development of some of the most complex signal injection software on the Net. They refer to the main software they use for their general broadcasts as "The Cannon."

It is well known that WSPY possesses the ability to send whatever they want, wherever they want and it could never be traced back to them. Certain members of WSPY run side businesses where, for a fee, they'll perform hit operations on Domains and hardware all across the Net.

WSPY operates out of its radio station, WSPY Station. Part of the station is an open lounge and bar for anyone to hang out and discuss their love of music, radio, or any other topics they enjoy. WSPY often takes on new members, especially recently, as they seem to be growing their underground group into a media empire. Currently, they have 12 different DJ shows in their rotation, and are training 3 new DJs to run even more shows.

Red Apiary

Red Apiary is a faction operating within the Torrent that primarily functions as a supplier of Nectar, the primary method for administering a digital drug known as Dopaminergic Rapid Internal Production or D.R.I.P. They maintain their influence by controlling who can buy, move, and store Nectar within their claimed zones. Dependent users, particularly those addicted to the substance, are often forced into their hierarchy as scouts, runners, and maintenance labor. In exchange, they receive limited access to Nectar. This structure allows Red Apiary to expand its control while reinforcing internal loyalty using Nectar as a leash.

The organization operates through a tiered structure built around territorial control. Higher-ranking members oversee zones of influence, coordinate the movement of supplies, and manage internal discipline, while lower-ranking members handle transport, storage, and monitoring of access points. Red Apiary avoids centralized headquarters, instead relying on overlapping safe zones and temporary operational sites that can be abandoned and rebuilt.

Red Apiary's visual identity is restrained but recognizable. Their territory and members are marked through repeating geometric symbols resembling gold honeycombs placed on red banners or patches. These markers serve not only as identifiers, but as a warning. While they do not own Centauri Street, the area is commonly treated as part of their influence, marked by hidden and covert tags used to indicate Nectar distribution spots.

Their long-term influence is measured less by the size of their territory and more by how many Torrentites they have addicted to their supply of Nectar.

Bristles

Bristles is an underground vart collective operating inside the Torrent, known mostly through rumor and the occasional trace of unauthorized visuals left behind in unexpected places. They aren't a formal faction and don't maintain territory the way other gangs do. Instead, Bristles moves through the Torrent in scattered, shifting clusters, leaving behind work that the Board would classify as wasteful or subversive.

What makes Bristles notable isn't just the art they create, but the intent behind it. Their members hold the belief that the conglomerate's suppression of creativity has caused a kind of slow decay in the human psyche, an erosion of expression and imagination. To them, the Torrent is one of the last places where unfiltered creation can still happen, even if only for a moment before other tags build upon it. As such, their work is meant to evoke emotions, to remind people that something as rare as creativity and art still exists.

Most Bristles members hide their identities, using throwaway handles or no identifiers at all. Their organizational structure is loose, almost nonexistent, relying on trust, quiet exchanges, and shared ideals rather than hierarchy. Some members specialize in bypassing filters, others in creating the art itself, and a few, usually the most skilled, focus on embedding their work deep enough that it takes significant effort for the Board to erase it.

Now and then, a Bristles piece appears on the Net and survives for longer than expected. Users treat these as small anomalies or lucky finds. For Bristles, each successful piece is a win.

The Rockers

The Rockers are the new guys on the block. A recently formed gang in Centauri Street, the Rockers love two things: music and money. They will do business with just about anyone in the pursuit of money. Their main source of income is the sale, transportation, and acquisition of odds and ends. Did someone else own these items? That is not going to stop a Rocker from completing their job. Other Centauri Street gangs see them as a threat to the unstable peace that exists in Centauri Street. As a new gang, they lack connections to other existing organizations that tie down the big gangs from breaking the peace and starting a massive gang war.

Steve's Angels

Steve's Angels is a pirate group turned mining that primarily focuses on the collection and distribution of raw ores and materials. While originally a pirate group, Steve's Angels became quite skilled at gathering large quantities of rare materials from all over known space. They began to work odd jobs for a few companies to pay for equipment. The group is as likely to poach shipments of ore as they are to mine it themselves, but they've made themselves a lynchpin of the interstellar mineral industry.

The Board is aware of Steve's Angels. However, Board analysts say that arresting them would likely burst the rapidly growing deep-space mining bubble. Because of this, the Board gave them an offer to register as an official business, in return for only arresting a handful of their members. Steve's Angels refused. Legend says they even dared the Board to try to arrest them. Since then, they've operated without regulation. Any time a member of this group is arrested, they get bailed out by the groups' many corporate clients.

While Steve's Angels does not have any official presence in the Torrent, they are connected with some of the city's most powerful gangs. Many Torrentites see Steve's Angels as more corporate shills despite the group's insistence that they will always be pirates first. Their representatives often find themselves unwelcome amongst the general population.

Stephen Stone

Stephen Stone is a liaison between the Steve's Angels Mining Company and their contacts in the Torrent. People say he's a bit of a strange person; no one in their right mind would go by their full legal name when operating in the Torrent. Although rumor has it that his name was the only reason Steve's Angels hired him, leading many to speculate that it's part of his contract.

He regularly meets with contacts from some of the Torrent's most notorious gangs, making him a person of interest for Torrentites looking for connections.

Hornet

Hornet is a hitman working out of Centauri Street. She's one of the most well-known and feared names in the business, with a reputation for professionalism and efficiency. Her close connections with a gang known as the Black Ties afford her comfort and security in the Torrent.

Her contract is expensive, but by all accounts, worth the cost. Few targets have escaped her in her nearly 15-year-long career. She doesn't speak much and tends to lie low, even when she's not undercover, giving her an air of mystery that wraps the imagination. Her elusive mystique has made her something of a legend in the Torrent, with some believing she's some kind of creepypasta made up to scare the enemies of the Black Ties.

Mr Whiskers

Mr. Whiskers is a crime boss from Centauri Street who leads a gang known as The Black Ties. Mr Whiskers most often takes on the guise of a small housecat with tuxedo-patterned fur, but is capable of taking on other forms as well. Mr Whiskers doesn't identify with any particular gender, and often swaps between them as easily as swapping their avatar. However, regardless of whether the Boss appears as a man, woman, or cat, Mr Whiskers will respond only to "Mr Whiskers" or "Boss".

There are all kinds of legends surrounding the eccentric crime boss and his rise to power. The most common story credits Mr Whiskers with starting and ending the violent gang war that raged across Centauri Street several years ago. He was completely unknown beforehand and emerged from the violence as the district's top crime lord.

The story goes that he used his shapeshifting abilities to pose as members and leaders of several Centauri Street crime syndicates, pushing them towards violence until they all destroy each other. Regardless of the story's truth, in the current day, The Boss is a legend, and people still wonder how many of the Torrent's most notorious crime bosses might really be Mr Whiskers in disguise.

IO

IO is a hacker active within Torrent, recognized exclusively for her work for sale in The Circle. No verified information exists about her origin, offline identity, or background. All records, references, and exchanges involving her use only the handle "IO," and there are no other known aliases or personal identifiers attached to her avatar. She has removed all traces of her personal history, leaving no recoverable metadata behind.

IO is regarded as a systems broker and high-level infiltrator specializing in the theft of information from organizational networks, both conglomerate and Torrent factions. She specializes in slipping into secured systems, extracting specific data packets, and leaving before the intrusion is detected.

She maintains no formal affiliation with any major Torrent faction and avoids entanglement with their internal politics. This neutrality appears deliberate, as by refusing to align herself with any group, she preserves access to a wide range of targets and maintains her position as a reliable source of illicit information. Her discretion has made her a preferred contractor for groups unwilling to risk exposing themselves in direct data theft.

Outside these exchanges, almost nothing is known. IO does not engage in extended communication, does not participate in social spaces, and does not leave identifiable artifacts in the Torrent. Her presence is observed only in brief intervals. Appearing, completing the transaction or extraction, and disappearing again without leaving a trace.

Vespa

Vespa is one of the few names on Centauri Street that people never say out loud. Everyone knows she's Red Apiary, but she doesn't move like the others, no posturing, no gang theatrics, none of that. She walks the street the way scissors slice through fabric, quiet and straight to the point, and the gangs let her do whatever she wants. Stories about how she rose through their ranks never match, but the common thread is simple: she carved out a place for herself in Red Apiary, fast enough and violently enough that no one questioned her.

Most people know her by the gold stinger patch she wears on her sleeve. You see it, or rather, her, and you stop whatever you were planning to do. Her territory isn't the biggest, but it's the kind most users intentionally route around. Vespa primarily handles Red Apiary's retaliation and border work. In moments when another gang pushes too far, someone tries to skim Nectar off the top, or an outsider digs into something they shouldn't, she intervenes. Her actions are always sudden and clean, the kind of response that teaches people not to test them a second time. Even Apiary members seem to fear her; when she needs to bring her subordinates in line, she hardly even has to speak.

THE BASICS OF PLAY

CHAPTER 02

The Torrent uses a variety of terms and rules that you will need to understand in order to play. This Chapter will introduce you to all of the necessary terms and fundamental rules so that you will be prepared to make an Operator of your own and start playing.

PART 1 :: SKILLS & TRAITS

An Operator's Skills represent their aptitude in performing certain activities in Cyberspace. In certain situations, players will be required to make rolls, or Skill Checks, that determine the outcome of their actions. Each Skill has a Skill Rank from 1 to 5 that determines the number of Rank Dice you use when performing a Skill Check with that Skill.

An Operator's Traits represent their innate mental qualities that allow them to push their limits in a wide variety of situations. There are three Traits: Cool, Humanity, and Intellect. All 3 Traits are related to 6 of the 18 Skills an Operator possesses. Traits act as pools of spendable Points to increase the number of dice you roll when making a Skill Check related to that Trait. The applicable Skills are listed beneath the Traits on the character sheet. For more information on spending Trait Points, see "Trait Points" on page 023.

Cool

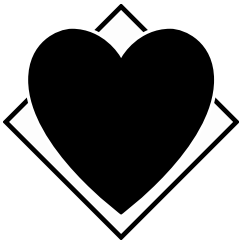


The Cool Trait represents one's ability to stay calm under pressure and take control of situations. An Operator with high Cool reacts quickly and decisively, manipulates conversations, and works better under stress.

Skills in the Cool Trait are often aligned with an Operator's ability to remain calm and collected under pressure, to perform certain clandestine tasks, and to present oneself with a distinct, natural swagger.

Aura Intimidation and awe. Used when manipulating others with your natural presence.	Aware Passive perception and attention to detail. Used to determine whether you notice something.
Conceal Stealth and sleight of hand. Used when obscuring an action, item, or one's own presence.	Deceive Verbal misdirection and cunning. Used when lying or concealing your thoughts and intentions.
Perform Acting and music. Used when attempting to entertain or distract.	Reflex Swiftness and reaction time. Used when performing activities that require quick and decisive actions

Humanity



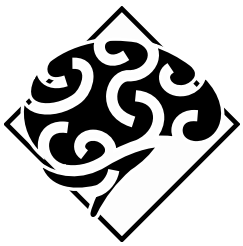
The Humanity Trait represents one's connection to their human nature. An Operator with high Humanity has strong willpower, understands themselves, connects deeply with others, and can resist the digital rules of the Net.

Skills in the Humanity Trait are often aligned with an Operator's connection with their material self, their ability to empathize with and empower others, and to manipulate their avatar with ease.

Appearance Disguise and seduction. Used when attempting to use your appearance to influence or fool others.	Converse Persuasion and eloquence. Used when trying to convince someone to do something with reason or argument.
Insight Emotional intelligence and natural intuition. Used when trying to gauge someone's true intentions or emotions.	Inspire Motivation and agitation. Used when trying to encourage someone or rile up their emotions.

Resist Determination and willpower. Used when applying your will or resisting the will of others.	Soothe De-escalation and pacification. Used when trying to get someone to be calm.

Intellect



The Intellect Trait represents one's ability to take in information and solve complex problems. An Operator with high Intellect can create and fix Software, break into encrypted systems, and see things others can't.

Skills in the Intellect Trait are often aligned with an Operator's problem-solving ability, including their ability to create programs, decipher encrypted information, and find hidden meanings or clues in their environment.

Debug Exploitation and manipulation of Software. Used when fixing or finding flaws in Software.	Decipher Decryption and deduction. Used when trying to derive information from deliberately obscured or confounding data
Interface Interact with complex systems and tools. Used when attempting to navigate or operate an unfamiliar system.	Know Recollection and connections. Use when determining if your character would have useful information or connections.
Program Creating and modifying Software. Used when attempting to create or modify Software.	Search Tracking and locating hidden things. Used when actively searching for something.

PART 2 :: GENERAL TERMINOLOGY

The Torrent uses several important terms integral to its game mechanics. This section covers only essential terminology for gameplay and character creation. For an exhaustive list of terms used throughout this book, reference the "The torrent Index" on page 070.

Entities

The term Entity refers to anything in Cyberspace with agency. This includes human Operators, but it also includes autonomous programs like Viruses.

Dice Notation

When referring to dice rolls in The Torrent, the number and type of dice used are annotated in the following format:

(number of dice)D(number of sides on the dice)+(additional modifiers).

For instance, the expression 1D12+2D6 refers to rolling 1 twelve-sided die (D12) and 2 six-sided dice (D6).

Action Die

The Action Die is a twelve-sided die (D12) that is always rolled when determining the result of using a Skill. A player will usually only roll one Action Die. For more information on Skill Checks, see "Part 3 :: Taking Action" on page 022.

Rank Dice

Rank Dice are six-sided dice (D6), which a player can roll up to 6 of when determining the result of using a Skill. The number of Rank Dice used depends on the Skill used, and a player might not always roll any Rank Dice. For more information on Skill Checks, see "Part 3 :: Taking Action" on page 022.

Avatar Abilities

Avatar Abilities are special rules or actions specific to an Operator that modifies the way they play. These abilities can be either Active (used to cause an instantaneous effect) or Passive (continuously granting some benefit). Avatar Abilities are directly tied to an Operator's subconscious identity. These abilities often manifest alongside physical changes to the avatar itself. For more information, as well as a comprehensive list of Avatar Abilities, see "Part 1 :: Avatar Abilities" on page 033

Speed

Speed refers to how many meters an Entity can move in a single Turn of combat. This Stat can be affected by various Status Effects and environmental factors. For more information on combat and Turns, see "Part 3 :: Movement and Position" on page 044.

Stability

In Cyberspace, a digital consciousness can become Destabilized if it becomes overwhelmed with information. When this happens, the consciousness can cease functioning. Stability represents an Entity's ability to sustain the effects of Destabilization. If an Entity becomes fully Destabilized, they will die. For more Information on Stability, "Part 4 :: Stability &

Destabilization" on page 024

Firewall

An Entity's Firewall represents how difficult it is for other Entities to resist the effects of Software running on that Entity's system. Operators that are more intelligent have higher Firewall. For more information on Software, see "Part 1 :: Software" on page 037

Hardware Slots

An Operator's Hardware Slots represents the maximum amount of Hardware upgrades they can have equipped at a time. The number of Hardware Slots an Operator possesses is always 3. For more information on Hardware, see "Part 2 :: Hardware" on page 042

RAM

An Entity's RAM represents a cap on the amount of Software that Entity can run concurrently. Each Software will have a listed RAM cost to run on a given Turn. For more information on Software, see "Part 1 :: Software" on page 037

Gear

The equipment, both physical and digital, that an Operator utilizes to gain advantages or facilitate actions in Cyberspace is referred to as Gear. Your Hardware and Software act as an Operator's weapons, armor, and tools for interacting with the Net. For more on Gear, see "Gear" on page 037

Hardware

Hardware refers to the physical equipment that an Operator has installed on their STEM system. There are two types of Hardware: Trigger (Hardware that creates an effect only when certain conditions are met) and Augment (Hardware that modifies an existing Stat as long as it is installed). For more information on Hardware, see "Part 2 :: Hardware" on page 042

Software

Software refers to the digital programs an Operator has access to in Cyberspace. Software can either be Persistent (It produces a lasting effect as long as it is active) or Instantaneous (It creates an instantaneous effect as soon as it activates). For more information on Software, see "Part 1 :: Software" on page 037

Software Crash

Some effects can cause an Operator's Software to deactivate against their will. This is known as a Crash. When Software crashes, it immediately deactivates and any effects it was creating go away.

Fatigue

An Operator's Fatigue Level represents how many exhausting actions they have taken while in Cyberspace. Each Level of Fatigue has cumulative effects on the Operator. For more information on Fatigue, see "Fatigue" on page 022.

PART 3 :: TAKING ΔCTION

In The Torrent, players are required to roll dice to determine the outcome of attempting certain tasks. When a player attempts to do something where the outcome of that action is in question, they roll, referred to as a Skill Check, using their Operator's Skills to modify their dice pool. Players do not need to roll on actions that are considered trivial or impossible, as the outcomes of these actions are not in doubt.

What does and doesn't warrant a Skill Check, and which Skill is required to complete a task, is up to the discretion of the DMM. Asking the players to describe the actions their characters take to complete a task can help the DMM decide which Skill is appropriate and encourages the players to roleplay. The DMM should also set a Difficulty Rating (DR) for the Skill Check, which is a number that represents how easy or difficult the task is.

When a player makes a Skill Check, they roll two types of dice, an Action Die and some number of Rank Dice. The Action Die is twelve-sided (D12), and the player will always roll exactly one when making a Skill Check. The Rank Dice are six-sided (D6), and the player rolls a number of them equal to the appropriate Skill's Rank. Certain sources may add to the number of Rank Dice used during a Skill Check. However, the total number of Rank Die rolled can never exceed 6.

If the total value shown on the dice meets or exceeds the DR set by the DMM, the player succeeds the Skill Check and completes whatever task they were attempting. If the number rolled does not meet or exceed the DR, the player fails the Skill Check. In the case of a failure, the player usually doesn't achieve their goal. However, the DMM may choose to allow the player to succeed with an added complication, such as the action wasting time and resources or nearby enemies being alerted.

There are some additional outcomes based on what is rolled during a Skill Check. If a 1 is rolled on the Action Die, the Skill Check fails regardless of the total value of the roll. This is known as a Critical Failure, and may come with additional consequences chosen by the DMM.

If a 12 is rolled on the Action Die, the player may roll the Action Die again and add the rolled value to the total. This is called a Lucky Break and can happen any number of times during a single Skill Check.

Opposed Rolls

Opposed Rolls should occur when multiple Entities attempt the same action at the same time or attempt actions that conflict with each other. For instance, contests of strength, games of strategy, and debates should be ruled as Opposed Rolls. In this case, rather than rolling against a DR set by the GM, the player and whatever is opposing them both make a Skill Check, and the one with the higher total rolled value wins the Opposed Roll. In the case of a tie, the winner is the one with a higher value shown on their Action Die. If it is still a tie, the roll should be repeated until there is a winner.

Momentum

Momentum represents a Crew's collective energy and collaborative flow. Momentum, individually known as Momentum Points, is a shared resource that can be generated or spent by any Crew member, stored in a Crew's Momentum Pool. A Crew's maximum Momentum is determined by the number of its members, each member increasing the Momentum Pool's capacity by 1. A Crew's current Momentum Points should be tracked by the Crew as a whole.

When an Operator joins a Crew, the Crew's maximum Momentum is increased, but no additional Momentum is added to the pool. The Crew can generate Momentum by rolling a 6 at any time on a Rank Die during a successful Skill Check, provided that they are not rolling against another member of their own Crew (ex. Two players having an arm wrestle making contested resist rolls). Each 6 rolled adds 1 Point to the Momentum Pool unless the Pool would exceed its capacity.

Spending Momentum allows players to add Rank Dice (D6) to their Skill Checks. Each Point spent adds one Rank Die. Momentum must be used as a lump sum, meaning that a player has to use all of it at once or none at all. Players may choose to use Momentum before they have rolled their Skill Check or before both they and their opposition make an Opposed Roll. Players may not retroactively spend Momentum after they roll.

If the Crew splits, any Momentum accrued before the split is lost. Each new group has its own Momentum Pool with a maximum determined by its number of members. Operators operating alone do not have a Momentum pool. When a separated Crew reunites, any accrued Momentum is combined. Momentum is reset back to 0 whenever the Crew rests. For more information on Rests, see "Part 2 :: Rest" on page 034

Bonus & Penalty

Certain scenarios may be favorable or unfavorable towards a player making a Skill Check. When this happens, that player should roll 2 Action Dice and use the higher or lower result to calculate the roll's total value. This is called rolling with a Bonus and a Penalty, respectively.

In general, whether a player rolls with a Bonus or a Penalty is up to the discretion of the DMM. The DMM should decide if they believe the situation would warrant favorable or unfavorable odds of completing a task. However, certain abilities and effects may also apply a Bonus or a Penalty to a roll.

The effects of a Bonus or a Penalty do not stack, meaning that if you would get a Bonus or a Penalty from more than one source, you would still only roll one additional Action Die. If a roll would be made with both a Bonus and a Penalty, the roll should instead be performed with neither a Bonus nor a Penalty. This is true even if the number of sources applying a Bonus outnumbers the number of sources applying a Penalty, and vice versa.

Trait Points

When making a Skill Check, a player may use their Operator's Trait Points to increase the number of Rank Dice they roll. Each Trait has its own Pool of Points that can only be spent on Skills related to that Trait. Each Trait Point spent adds 1 additional Rank Die to the roll. A player may choose to spend any number of Trait Points before they roll a Skill Check. Players may not retroactively spend Trait Points after they roll. Players can regain Trait Points by resting. For more information on Resting, see "Part 2 :: Rest" on page 034

When a player depletes one of their Trait Pools, that Trait is considered to be Exhausted. This Trait will remain Exhausted until the Trait Pool regains at least 1 Point. An Exhausted Trait can be stabilized by another player using a DR 10 Skill Check, depending on the Trait. When a Trait is Stabilized, the Trait Pool is restored to one Trait Point.

While a Trait is Exhausted, all Skill Checks related to that Trait are rolled with a Penalty. Each Trait also has a unique effect when Exhausted.

Cool

When an Operator's Cool is Exhausted, they have lost their ability to stay calm under pressure. This can be roleplayed as a nervous break or distress. Another player will need to calm them down using their Soothe Skill to stabilize their Cool.

While your Cool is exhausted, Skill Checks related to Cool are rolled with a Penalty and your Speed is halved.

Humanity

When an Operator's Humanity is Exhausted, they have become emotionally exhausted. This can be roleplayed as disassociation or inability to control their emotions. Another player will need to reinvigorate them using their Inspire Skill to stabilize their Humanity.

While your Humanity is exhausted, Skill Checks related to Humanity are rolled with a Penalty, and all Damage sources deal one additional Point of Stability.

Intellect

When an Operator's Intellect is Exhausted, they have become mentally exhausted. This can be roleplayed as being stunned or confused. Another player will need to talk them through it using their Converse Skill to stabilize their Intellect.

While your Intellect is exhausted, Skill Checks related to Intellect are rolled with a Penalty, and your Firewall DR becomes 10.

Roleplaying Exhausted Traits is encouraged, as it's a good way to communicate to other members of your Crew that it needs to be restabilized. Additionally, the DMM should reward good roleplay by granting a Bonus or even allowing the player to succeed automatically if their performance is good.

PART 4 :: STABILITY & DESTABILIZATION

When you jack into the Net, you are effectively transferring your consciousness out of your brain and onto the wider Net. Doing this makes your mind malleable and able to be Damaged by effects from Cyberspace. However, the average Operator isn't in much danger. The standard digital world can only just barely affect it, unless your path takes you into dark corners of the Net where Viruses lurk and dangerous Software is common.

In order to exist within Cyberspace, an Entity's digital consciousness needs to remain stable. A Destabilized Virus or other autonomous actor would simply cease to function; however, an Operator would become unable to return to their body in real space. Most often, this results in Destabilization, as the Operator's mind becomes too unstable to retain a sense of self and dissipates. Stability has two parts: a Pool of Stability Points and a Stability Level.

Stability Level

A Stability Level represents a mental breaking point for an Entity. An Entity has 2 Stability Levels by default. Each Level represents a Pool of Stability Points. When an Entity loses a Stability Level, all currently running Software Crashes, and they gain a Level of Fatigue. Stability Levels cannot be regained without leaving Cyberspace. When an Entity's Stability Level reaches zero, they Destabilize.

Stability Points

Stability Points represent an Entity's more fluid mental State. An Entity's Stability Point Pool is determined by their Humanity Trait. Damage taken from Software and other Attacks is subtracted from your Stability Points. When an Entity's Stability Points equals zero or less, they lose a Stability Level and return to their maximum Stability Points, unless their Stability Level becomes zero.

Destabilization

When an Operator's Stability Levels drop to zero, their mind completely fades into the background data of the Net, taking their Avatar with it. Their Avatar dissipates, and their mind is irreparable. Their body becomes functionally brain-dead, as their consciousness will never return to it. Don't be too disappointed if your Operator Destabilizes though. Character death can make for excellent roleplay, and you can always create a new character to play.

For non-Operator Entities, Destabilizing means immediate and irreversible destruction.



CHARACTER CREATION

CHAPTER 03



In The Torrent, you play as an Operator, a human who enters Cyberspace while in an induced sleep, controlling an Avatar within this digital world. An Operator's Avatar represents who they are as a person; it is their subconscious and their identity manifesting in Cyberspace. Who your character is as a person should affect what they can do in Cyberspace. This section of the rulebook outlines and guides players through the Character Creation process, including creating their history, their personality, and their career. It is recommended to read the entirety of the Character Creation chapter before attempting to create a character.

You will create an Avatar, a digital appearance, for your Operator. Think about whether they appear tall or short in Cyberspace. Are they humanoid? Black hair or green? These questions put your conceptual Operator into the world and allow you to begin developing a sense of connection with them.

When creating your Operator, it is important to remember that The Torrent system takes place in the dream-like world of Cyberspace, allowing your Operator to present differently from the way they look in the real world. An Avatar's appearance is tied to the subconscious, so it can Range from an identical copy of their real body, to something completely inhuman in nature.

Software that changes an Operator's Avatar is common, especially in The Torrent. However, these changes are purely cosmetic and any added appendages aren't functional and they cannot change the size of your Avatar. Only one's true identity can create functional additions like those, in the rules, these changes are represented by Avatar Abilities.

It is standard for an Operator to be reminiscent of their human counterparts, but anything goes in Cyberspace. GO WILD!

Overview and Quick Reference

Choose or Create a Background	Choose a Background from Table 3-1 and allocate 3 Skill Ranks among its listed 5 Skills in any fashion.
Choose or Create an Occupation	Choose an Occupation from Table 3-2 and allocate 3 Skill Ranks among its listed 5 Skills in any fashion
Allocate your Skill Ranks	Allocate 8 Additional Skill Ranks among any of the 18 Skills of your choosing.
Check: Total Ranks	You should have allocated a total of 14 Skill Ranks.
Calculate Your Trait Pools	Calculate and fill in your Cool, Humanity, and Intellect Trait values.
Calculate Your Speed, Stability, and Firewall	Calculate and fill in your Speed, Stability, and Firewall values.
Check: Diamonds Above Skills	Each diamond above your Skills should now be filled in with a caluclated value
Choose Your Starting Hyperstim Weapon	Choose one Hyperstim Software from Table 3-3 and add it to your Software list
Choose Your Starting Software	Choose any 2 Software from Table 3-4 and/or Table 3-5 and add it to your Software list.
Choose Your Starting Hardware	Choose 1 Hardware from Table 3-6 and add it to your Hardware list.
Choose Your Starting Avatar Abilities	Choose 1 Avatar Ability from Table 3-7 and add it to your Avatar Ability list.
Check: Starting Gear	Ensure you have: 1 Hyperstim Software, 2 Additional Software, 1 Hardware, 1 Avatar Ability

PART 1 :: BACKGROUND/ OCCUPATION

Ask yourself questions about who your Operator is, who they were, who they want to be.

Your Operator's Background and Occupation give roleplay elements weight. A Background is a reflection of your Operator's upbringing, what Skills they honed as a child, and what circumstances of their environment led them to become who they are today. An Occupation, on the other hand, reflects what your Operator does within Cyberspace, what brought them to The Torrent, and what Skills they honed in their trade.

Backgrounds and Occupations can be as extensive or minimal as you choose, as its effects, while partly mechanical, are mostly to be used by you and your party to create interesting character arcs and stories.

You may either create a Background and Occupation of your choosing, or use any of the preset Backgrounds and Ocupations found in "Table 3-1 - Common Backgrounds, and the Skill Ranks/Torrum they Recommend:" and "Table 3-2 - Common Occupations and the Skill Ranks they recommend:" below.

If you are creating your own Background and Occupation, you should think about what kinds of Skills your character would have gained from your Background and Occupation and allocate 6 Skill Ranks accordingly. For more information on Skills, see "Part 1 :: Skills & Traits" on page 020. Make sure to read through the creation steps to ensure you don't miss details that aren't preset, such as Allies, Debts, and Enemies. These aspects of Character Creation are done best when discussed with your DMM.

Background

When choosing a Background:

- Allocate 3 Skill Ranks however you like among the Skills you think your character would have gained from this Background.
  - Your Ranks in any Skill may not exceed 3 while in Character Creation. Additionally, no matter if you create or choose your Background, you should only be granted 3 total Skill Ranks from your Background and will allocate them yourself.
- Roll between 1 D4 and 6 D4, as specified by your Background (see "Table 3-1 - Common Backgrounds, and the Skill Ranks/Torrum they Recommend:") and multiply the added result by 10 to determine your starting balance of Torrum, the cryptocurrency accepted by most of The Torrent.
- Create at least one relevant person from your Background that you may be able to call upon for assistance, called an Ally. Additionally, create at least one Debt you may owe either a person or organization from your Background, as well as a brief story about it.

Write your Background, Ally or Allies, your Debt(s), and brief descriptions of them in their respective sections of your Character Sheet.

If you would like to create your own Background, ask yourself questions about your Operator's upbringing, what Skills they honed as a child, and what circumstances of their environment led them to become who they are today. Create a short description of this Background, a corresponding Background title, and grant yourself an appropriate balance of Torrum.

Table 3-1 - Common Backgrounds, and the Skill Ranks/Torrum they Recommend:

Name	Description	Skills	Torrum
Street Rat	You grew up rough on the streets of a planetary colony. You did what you needed to survive and experienced firsthand the violence of gangs and corporate security.	Deceive, Conceal, Reflex, Insight, Search	1d4 * 10 (25T)
Prodigy	From a young age, you were lauded by friends, family, and the system for your talents and natural abilities. You've always given everything 110%, even at the expense of your own well-being.	Perform, Inspire, Decipher, Interface, Know	4d4 * 10 (100T)

Name	Description	Skills	Torrum
Academy Educated	Most people got their education from corporate-affiliate schools that teach only the Skills necessary to become a good worker. Not you. You attended a private academy, rubbing shoulders with the elite and acquiring the Skills necessary to lead or forge your own path.	Aura, Converse, Decipher, Search, Know	5d4 * 10 (125T)
Corpo Scion	For you, wealth and power were always a given. Raised in the cutthroat world of corporate politics, you became accustomed to manipulating and using others to your own advantage.	Aura, Deceive, Aware, Insight, Appearance	6d4 * 10 (150T)
Spacer	You grew up in the cold metal hallways of a space station. The harsh conditions of living in space hardened you to adversity and taught you to form close bonds with those around you. Navigating the digital systems that manage your environment has given you a unique understanding of computer systems	Resist, Inspire, Soothe, Program, Debug	2d4 * 10 (50T)

Name	Description	Skills	Torrum
Gate Hopper	You've spent most of your life on the move. You never stayed in any star system for long, hopping back and forth across Hyperion Gates and smuggling yourself on cargo ships. The lonely life of a wanderer is all you've ever known, and you know your way around the ships and machinery.	Conceal, Aware, Program, Debug, Interface	3d4 * 10 (75T)
Disillusioned	You were brought up to believe in the promises of the corporations. Your middle-class life, supported by a low-Level corporate job, allowed you to believe in the corporate dream. But somewhere along the way, you woke up. You can't help but think your life up until now has been a lie.	Perform, Soothe, Converse, Insight, Appearance	5d4 * 10 (125T)
Veteran	You fought in The Second Corporate War. The horrors you experienced during your deployment left a deep impact on who you are now.	Conceal, Reflex, Resist, Inspire, Search	3d4 * 10 (75T)

Occupation

When choosing an Occupation:

Allocate 3 Skill Ranks however you like among the Skills you think your character would have gained from this Occupation.

Your Ranks in any Skill may not exceed 3 while in Character Creation. Additionally, no matter if you create or choose your Occupation, you should only be granted 3 total Skill Ranks from your Occupation and will allocate them yourself.

Create at least one relevant person or organization you've encountered in the course of your Occupation that may be out to get you, referred to as an Enemy. Additionally, create at least one Debt you may owe either a person or organization you accrued in the course of your Occupation, as well as a brief story about it. It is more important that you specify who the Debt is owed to than the nature of the Debt itself.

Write your Occupation, Enemy or Enemies, your Debt(s), and brief descriptions of them in their respective sections of your Character Sheet.

If you would like to create your own Occupation, consider what your Operator does within Cyberspace, what brought them to The Torrent, and what Skills they honed in their trade. Create a short description of this Occupation, and a corresponding Occupation title.

Table 3-2 - Common Occupations and the Skill Ranks they recommend:

Name	Description	Skills
Software Developer	A Torrentite responsible for using data packets to create and then pawn mundane digital items.	Converse, Aware, Program, Know, Interface
Retail Worker	A Torrentite that does just as mundane a job in The Torrent as could be done outside of it. You interact with customers and sell them products they request.	Soothe, Converse, Insight, Perform, Deceive
First Responder	A Torrentite that works to restore others' Stability or escort them out of The Torrent before they Destabilize.	Search, Soothe, Resist, Insight, Inspire
Hacker	A Torrentite that works to scrape and/or scrub data, information, or access from a variety of servers, old and new. This typically isn't legal in the wider Net, but in The Torrent this is a respected if also a somewhat concerning job to have.	Aura, Conceal, Program, Decipher, Debug
Gang Member	A Torrentite that is affiliated with a less than honorable unofficial faction. You make your money doing illicit jobs from muggings to the occasional robbery.	Appearance, Aura, Deceive, Reflex, Resist
Media Pirate	A Torrentite that scrounges through old servers to find any leftover pieces of media in order to clone and sell it across The Torrent.	Search, Debug, Decipher, Know, Inspire
Diplomat	A Torrentite that works as a messenger between factions in order to keep both sides' people out of harm's way. Your job is respected by almost all of the population of The Torrent. It's incredibly rare to hear of anyone "shooting the messenger" while you are doing your duties.	Soothe, Resist, Know, Perform, Converse

PART 2 :: SKILL RANK ALLOCATION

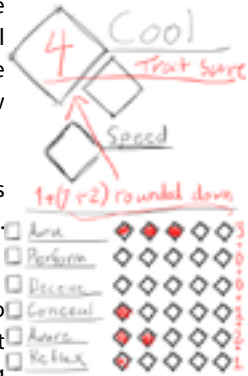
Each Operator starts with an additional 8 Skill Ranks (on top of those provided from your Background & Occupation), which you may freely allocate to the Skills on your Character Sheet. Throughout this step, you cannot put a Rank into a Skill that already has 3 or more Ranks already.

Once this is done you should have 14 total Skill Ranks across all the Skills on your Character Sheet.

You will now determine your Operator's Trait Scores and Trait Pools, as well as their associated Speed, Stability, and Firewall.

Trait Score

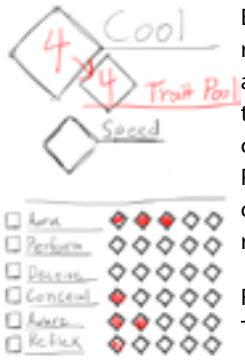
Each Trait Score is derived from the total number of Ranks between all the Skills related to that Trait. These Skills are listed in the column below the Trait on your Character Sheet.



Your Trait Score is equal to one plus half the total Ranks rounded up. (1+(Ranks/2)) rounded up.

This Score will also be referred to as the Trait itself, such as your Trait Score in the Cool column being called your Cool.

Trait Pool



Each Trait Pool is derived from the relevant Trait's Score. Your Trait Score also functions as your maximum total Trait Pool in its relevant column. The value of each Trait Pool represents the total number of Trait Points you can spend in that respective Trait.

Repeat this process for each of your Trait Pools.

Finally, to finish up your basic Skills and Traits you need to calculate your Trait-specific stats; your Speed, Stability, and Firewall.

Stats

Speed

Your Speed Stat determines how many meters your Operator can move on their Turn in Combat. Your speed is equal to 5 + Cool Trait Score. Write your Speed in its respective diamond on your Character Sheet.



Stability



Your Stability Points determine how tough it is to Destabilize you in Cyberspace. Your maximum Stability Points is equal to 7 + Humanity Trait Score.

The bottom-left diamond contains your maximum number of Stability Points per Stability Level. This is the value of each Stability Level you have.

The middle diamond is your current Stability Points. Begin with maximum Stability Points.

The bottom-right diamond contains your Stability Levels. This is how many times your Stability Points can be depleted before you Destabilize. Each Operator has 2 Stability Levels (mutable via Hardware).

Write your maximum Stability Points, current Stability Points, and beginning Stability Levels in their respective diamonds on your Character Sheet. For more information onf Destabilization, see "Part 4 :: Stability & Destabilization".

Firewall

Your Firewall Stat determines your Software's Difficulty Rating – how difficult it is to resist your Software. It's calculated via 10 + Intellect Trait Score.



Affected Entities will make Opposed Rolls against your Firewall DR when resisting Software effects originating from you that request a Firewall Save. Your Firewall DR is also used when affected Entities attempt to remove a Persistent Software applied to them that originated from you.

PART 3 :: OPERATOR GEAR AND ABILITIES

Now that you have begun developing your Operator, think about what kind of abilities your Operator may have.

While conflict in The Torrent may be resolved outside of violent means, it's best to be prepared. Any dope that walks into The Torrent without a means to defend themselves is liable to get their head knocked off.

How does your Operator fight? Do they prefer being an undying force at the head of the battle, or maybe more like an uncatchable annoyance, slinking away at a moment's notice? This section is where you will choose your Operator's starting Software, Hardware, and Avatar Abilities, allowing them to manipulate the rules of Cyberspace.

Starting Software

Untrained Operators in The Torrent can typically run a handful of harmless Software, things like calculators, data sorting algorithms, and cosmetics. However, to manipulate the Net and defend yourself from malicious Entities you encounter, you'll need something stronger.

Choose a Hyperstim Software from "Table 3-3 - Starting Gear, Hyperstim Software" below. Hyperstim Software, explained more in "Hyperstim" on page 046, is a type of Persistent Software, allowing the Operator to create and use a digital weapon of their choosing. These weapons often have innate abilities that cause additional effects when used or triggered.

Additionally, choose a total of 2 more Software from between "Table 3-4 - Starting Gear, Persistent Software" and "Table 3-5 - Starting Gear, Instantaneous Software". Afterwards, you should have 3 total Software, one of which being the Hyperstim Weapon chosen before. Write these Software in the Software section on your Character Sheet.

Table 3-3 - Starting Gear, Hyperstim Software

Name	RAM	Description	Mod	Range	DMG
Scoped Revolver	3	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim with the appearance of an old-timey revolver.	N/A	15	2
Arcane Staff	5	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim with the appearance of an arcane wizard's staff.	N/A	8	3
Warrior's Sword	4	Melee Creates a Hyperstim with the appearance of a medieval warrior's blade.	N/A	1	4
Jade Spear	3	Melee Creates a Hyperstim with the appearance of an Oriental jade staff.	N/A	3	3

Table 3-4 - Starting Gear, Persistent Software

Name	BOOT	RAM	Description	Range
Malware	1	4 + 4X	Once Booted, this Software sends an encrypted Virus as an indomitable missile towards the enemy Entity, dealing 1 Damage at the start of your Turn. You may increase the Damage dealt by X for every additional 4X RAM allocated for this instance of Malware.	8
Impregnable	1	4	Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Defense Rolls you make.	N/A
Indominable	1	4	Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Attack Rolls you make.	N/A
Icebreaker	0	6	Gain an additional Rank Die when rolling against a Firewall DR	N/A

Name	BOOT	RAM	Description	Range
Iron Boots	1	6	Once Booted, this Software applies the Grapple Status Effect to a target Entity.	6
Blind	2	8	Once Booted, this Software applies the Blind Status Effect on a target Entity.	6

Table 3-5 - Starting Gear, Instantaneous Software

Name	RAM	Description	DMG
Cryo Raycast	6	Create Slick Terrain in a line up to 5 meters in Line of Sight.	0
Pin Prick	6 + 2X	Choose up to 3 targets within Line of Sight. They take (1+X) Damage.	1 + X
Frayed Cables	8	Create a 2-Hex radius blast within Line of Sight, dealing 4 Damage to all targets inside.	4
Dreadnaught	6	Charge forward, ignoring any movement penalties, in a straight line up to half (rounding up) of your maximum Speed. Any target you pass through takes 2 Damage.	2

Starting Hardware

As any good Operator knows, "your Skills are only as good as your rig," and you better believe em'! Hardware is what allows Operators to access the Net, enhances their capabilities, and can even grant Operators new abilities in the right circumstances.

Hardware, explained more in "Part 2 :: Hardware" on page 042, is broken down into two separate categories by how their effects are implemented: Trigger and Augment. Trigger Hardware creates effects only when some condition is met, while Augment Hardware boosts an Operator's existing abilities.

Choose 1 Hardware from "Table 3-6 - Starting Gear, Hardware (T: Trigger, A: Augmenting)" below, to begin with. Write this Hardware in the Hardware section on your Character Sheet.

During this step, you should also determine your character's RAM, Fatigue Limit, and Hardware Slots. Each of these values start at a static default number, but can be augmented by the Hardware you select.

Your RAM determines how much Software you can run concurrently. Each Operator starts with 12 RAM.

Your Fatigue Limit represents how long your character can withstand the effects of staying in Cyberspace before seeing adverse effects. In gameplay, your Fatigue Limit is how many Levels of Fatigue you can accrue before Destabilization. Each Operator starts with a Fatigue Limit of 3.

Your Hardware Slots represent the maximum number of Hardware upgrades you can have installed at once. Each Operator starts with 3 Hardware Slots.

Table 3-6 - Starting Gear, Hardware (T: Trigger, A: Augmenting)

Name	TYPE	Description	Cost
Flow-State Chip	T	On a critical success, you generate 1 Point of Momentum	
Failsafe Computing Core	T	Whenever a Software crashes, you may immediately choose another Software that costs less RAM to boot instantaneously	
(Skill) Boost	A	Increase (Skill) Rank by 1	
More Sticks I	A	Your RAM increases by 2	

Starting Avatar Abilities

Each Operator has a certain number of innate abilities, external to the effects of any Software or Hardware, called Avatar Abilities. Avatar Abilities, explained more in "Part 1 :: Avatar Abilities" on page 033, are net-breaking effects that seem to manipulate the rules of Cyberspace, allowing Operators to perform certain actions others may not.

Choose 2 Avatar Abilities from "Table 3-7 - Starting Gear - Avatar Abilities(P: Permanent, A: Activated)". Write these Avatar Abilities in the Avatar Abilities section on your character sheet.

Table 3-7 - Starting Gear - Avatar Abilities(P: Permanent, A: Activated)

Name	TYPE	Description
Miniscule (Cannot Take Massive)	P	You're very small. You can move onto and occupy spaces that enemies occupy. You get an additional Rank Die when making Defense Rolls.
Massive (Cannot Take Miniscule)	P	You're very large. Enemies can move onto and occupy spaces that you occupy. You get an additional Rank Die when making Attack Rolls with a Melee Weapon.
Crucible	A	You can create a mundane metal item up to half a meter in volume.
Swole	P	you can carry heavy objects without encumbrance. You can lift very heavy objects without a Skill roll.
Moledig	A	Three times per Digital Rest, you may begin digging a tunnel, moving at half your max Speed, emerging from the tunnel wherever you please. Any future movement through the tunnel is also at half max Speed.
Slinky	P	When standing against a wall, your Speed is doubled. The extra Speed is lost when leaving the proximity of a wall.

PART 4 :: GETTING STRONGER

As you play through The Torrent, working through and finishing Gigs, defeating other Entities, your Operators will improve in various ways, such as gaining more and better Hardware and Software, more innate Avatar Abilities, and higher difficulty ceilings of Skill Checks.

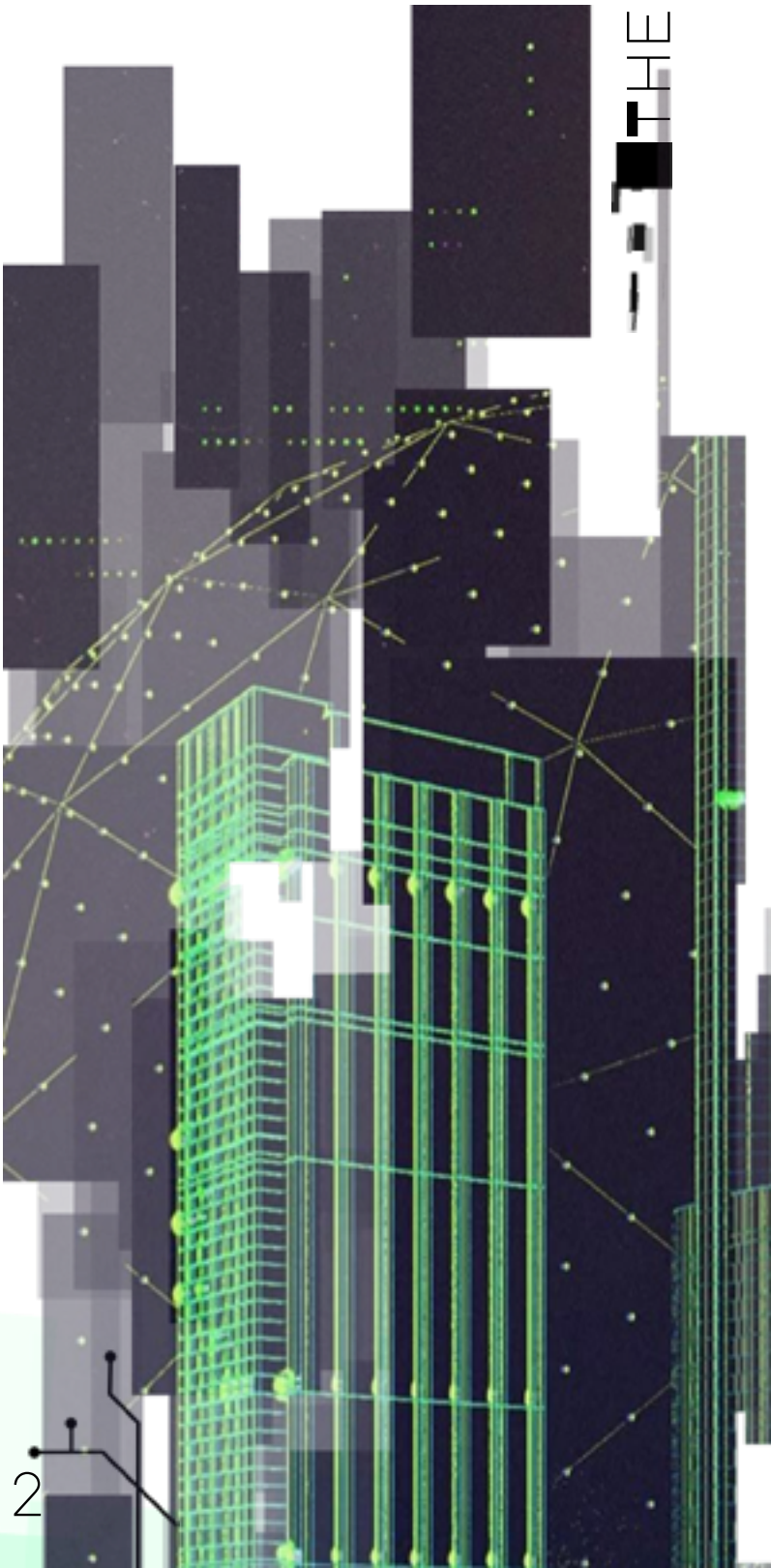
Milestones

The Torrent RPG works off of a milestone system, where character progression is determined primarily by the DMM, typically after the party or an individual has proven their mastery over their Skills. In such an event, or when the DMM determines, Operators should progress by gaining the following:

1 new Avatar Ability

3 Upgrade Challenges, you may perform an Upgrade Challenge, rolling a Skill Check against a DR 10 using the Skill to upgrade. A failure in the Skill Check upgrades the Skill Rank, to a max of 5 Ranks in each Skill.

This means you effectively get 3 attempts at these rolls. The higher the Skill you attempt it on, the more Rank Dice you'll roll to upgrade. This means that higher Rank Skills are harder to upgrade than lower Rank Skills.



SYSTEM DETAILS

CHAPTER 04



Becoming an Operator in Cyberspace means learning to play by the rules of the game, or learning how to bypass them. Operators in Cyberspace have certain innate abilities that allow them to manipulate or negate these rules. This chapter will cover what these systems are, how they operate, as well as the effects they have on your Operator, other Entities, and the Net in entirety.

PART 1 :: AVATAR ABILITIES

When an Operator enters Cyberspace, their mind imprints certain Traits and effects onto their Avatar and the digital world around them. These effects are referred to as Avatar Abilities. Avatar Abilities allow Operators to bend the rules of Cyberspace and push their own limitations. These abilities often manifest alongside physical changes to the avatar itself. One's Avatar Abilities are deeply tied to their identity and subconscious, making each Avatar a reflection of an Operator's inner world.

Some Avatar Abilities are Permanant, others are Activated. Permanent Avatar Abilities (Labelled with P in the table below) are always active and act as a constant buff. Activated Avatar Abilities (Labelled with A in the table below) must be activated with a Physical Action unless they are triggered by something listed in their descriptions.

Table 4-1 - Avatar Abilities

Name	TYPE	Description
Appraisal	A	Once per Digital Rest, you may reveal the functions of Agents and Software you encounter.
Crucible	A	You can create a mundane metal item up to half a meter in volume.
Determination	A	Once per Physical Rest, when you would be Destabilized, survive on one Stability Point instead
Fear	A	Once per Digital Rest, you may pick a target Entity. That Entity is frozen in fear and cannot move or take Physical Actions until the start of your next Turn.
Hot Blooded	A	You may cause any object up to 1 meter in size that you touch to heat up. Any Entity touching that object takes 1 Damage each Turn they are touching it.
Massive	P	You're very large. Enemies can move onto and occupy spaces that you occupy. You get an additional Rank Die when making Attack Rolls with a Melee Weapon. Increase the weight you can carry by one degree.
Miniscule	P	You're very small. You can move onto and occupy spaces that enemies occupy. You get an additional Rank Die when making Defense Rolls. Reduce the weight you can carry by one degree.
Moledig	A	Three times per Digital Rest, you may begin digging a tunnel, moving at half your max Speed, emerging from the tunnel wherever you please. Any future movement through the tunnel is also at half max Speed, ignoring Difficult and Slick Terrain. You are considered out of line of sight inside the tunnel, but cannot take Physical or Strategic Actions until you emerge.

Name	TYPE	Description
Multitasking	A	Once per Physical Rest, when you Boot a Software, you can choose to Boot a copy of that Software on the same Strategic Action.
Prat Fall	A	Once per Physical Rest, after making a Skill Check, you may flip a coin. If it's heads, you succeed on that Check; if it's tails, you fail that Check.
Rabbit's Foot	A	Once per Digital Rest, you may reattempt a Critical Failure on any Skill Check or Attack
Slinky	P	When standing against a wall, your Speed is doubled. The extra Speed is lost when leaving the proximity of a wall.
Sniper	A	Once per Physical Rest, if you hold an Attack on a target for one Turn, your next hit on that target is a Lucky Break.
Stubborn	P	You cannot be moved from your position against your will.
Sure-Footed	P	When rolling against becoming prone, roll with an additional Rank Die. You are unaffected by Difficult Terrain.
Swole	P	You can carry heavy objects without encumbrance. You can lift very heavy objects without a Skill Check.
Tea-Time	P	When you take a Digital Rest, restore an additional 1d4 healing.
Tireless	P	Your Fatigue Limit is increased by 1.
Trojan Horse	A	Once per Physical Rest, when one of your Software activates on a target, you may choose another Software that costs less RAM and has an equal or lower Boot time than the original Software. That Software's effect triggers instantly without any Boot time
Unstable Defibrillator	A	Once per Physical Rest, flip a coin. If it's heads, a target restores one Level of Stability; if it's tails, the target loses one Level of Stability.

PART 2 :: REST

Throughout any given Gig, Operators will need time to rest and recover. There are two distinct kinds of rest Operators can take: Digital Rest within the digital world of Cyberspace, and Physical Rest while disconnected, in Realspace.

Digital Rest

Going at least an hour without performing any strenuous or stressful activities in Cyberspace is considered a Digital Rest. When taking a Digital Rest, you may restore 1d4 Stability Points and recover 1 Trait Point in each of their Trait Pools. When taking a Digital Rest players can not regain Stability Levels. Each Operator loses a Level of Fatigue.

Physical Rest

Because operating in Cyberspace requires a heightened Level of brain activity, proper rest can only be taken while disconnected from the Net. Resting for at least 3 hours in Realspace is considered a Physical Rest. When taking a Physical Rest, a player restores all lost Stability Points and Stability Levels and regains all spent Trait Points. They also lose all Levels of Fatigue they may have.

Taking either a Digital or Physical Rest resets the Crew's Momentum to 0.

PART 3 :: FATIGUE

Fatigue represents the cumulative effects of a prolonged stay in Cyberspace on an Operator. Operators that remain too long in Cyberspace suffer malnutrition, mental decline, psychotic episodes, and eventually death. Each Operator has a Fatigue Limit, beyond which they will experience ill effects. By default, each Operator has a Fatigue Limit of 3.

Operators lose a Level of Fatigue each time they take a Digital Rest. An Operator's Fatigue is reset to zero when they take a Physical Rest

The following table describes the effects of Fatigue.

Table 4-3 - Fatigue Effects

Fatigue Level	Effects
1	-1 Rank Dice on all Rolls
2	Choose one Trait Pool (Cool, Humanity, or Intellect) and deplete all Trait Points in that Pool.

Fatigue Level	Effects
3	Deplete all Trait Points in all Trait Pools.
4	You cannot add Rank Dice when making rolls.
5+	You Destabilize.

PART 4 :: BROWSERS

Navigating the Net can be dangerous, especially when going from place to place in abandoned areas with no formal transportation. Rogue AI, Viruses, and decaying parts of the Net are all things that could Destabilize any individual caught out floating. To remedy this problem Torrentites have created a solution to explore the abandoned Net, as well as fortify against hostile places overall.

A Browser is a form of weaponized transportation designed to travel between Domains through Netspace while more safely housing their consciousnesses during travel. Most Browsers give off the appearance of a spaceship of some kind, however, this is not universal. A Browser can look like just about anything, provided it's some style of vehicle. That means yes, you could have a flying car, or a replica of a ship from your favorite media, or even a giant boat spaceship.

Using A Browser

In order to use a Browser your Crew needs to be near one in the first place. Ownership does not matter, assuming you can Interface with the controls inside the Browser. Browsers are mostly universal in how they operate, so not only can someone who can use a Browser use many others, but in addition, the Stats of a Browser are almost entirely dictated by those who are controlling it. Each Browser can be simultaneously piloted by all of the Operators inside of it that want to be controlling it provided the Browser can accommodate that many pilots.

Browser Combat

A Browser effectively operates like one unit when in combat. However, for each of its Physical and Strategic Actions, any of the participating Operators may choose to use their Rank in the relevant Skill to make any Skill Checks. This includes both Attack and Defense rolls as well. All Operators also contribute every Software they have to the options of what their Browser can do. This means as a single unit, a Browser can be boosted in its entirety by a single Software and that an opposing Browser can be debuffed in its entirety by a single Software. In addition, Hyperstim Weapons also function against a single opposing Browser in the same way they would a single Entity.

Browser Health

Your Browser's health is each Interfacing Operator's Stability Points added together. Your Browser only has 2 Stability Levels.

A Browser is on a different Damage scale than an Operator outside of one. A Browser is far tougher than an Operator. This is represented in that for every 10 Damage from an Operator against a Browser, the Browser will lose 1 Stability Point. This number is also rounded up.

Ex: An Operator attacks a Browser for 13 Damage in one attack. The Browser loses 2 Stability Points. If an Operator attacks a Browser for even as low as 3 Damage, the Browser will still lose 1 Stability Point.

Inversely, a Browser amplifies all attacks from interfacing Operators against Operators outside of a Browser. This is represented in that for every 1 Damage from a Browser against an Operator, the Operator will lose 10 Stability Points.

Ex: A Browser attacks an Operator for a 3 Damage attack. The Operator now takes 30 Damage from the attack.

Browser RAM

Your Browser's Total RAM equals the total RAM of participating Operators.

Browser Firewall

Your Browser's Firewall is equals 10+the total amount of operators Interfacing with the Browser.s

Browser Actions

Your Browser has a lot of power to process and do things with all those Operators' Interfacing together. This is shown in the amount of actions it can take.

Your Browser has as many Physical Actions as it has Operators interfacing with it.

Your Browser has as many Strategic Actions as it has Operators interfacing with it.

Your Browser does not have the ability to move automatically on each of its Turns.

Browser Movement

Your Browser is cumbersome to move with all of your Crew moving together, but that doesn't mean your maximum Speed is low!

Your Browser's Speed is set by the ship's size and grade, but

it can be given a bonus by the highest Cool Stat of all the participating Operators. This number is then divided, as defined by their ship's size, and rounded up.

Ex: 5 Cool on a small ship adds 3 movement speed to their ship. That means the ship's movement speed is now 7. The same 5 Cool adds 1 movement speed on a large ship, yielding a total of 2 movement speed to their ship, as the size of either ship changes how much their Cool gets divided by.

Movement takes a Physical Action to do.

Additional Browser Stats

Though most of a Browser's Stats are dictated by the Operators Interfacing with it, there are a few key Stats that are dependent on the size and quality of the Browser itself.

Interfaces:
The maximum number of Operators that can pilot (Interface) a Browser at once. This typically dictates how many sources of Stat increases it can get.

X Hex Movements:
The base number of hexes a Browser can move per Move action taken.

+ Top Cool÷X:
The highest individual Cool Trait between all of the Interfacing Operators is divided by X and rounded up. This number is then added to the base Hex Movements a ship has to create the total number of Hexes a Browser can move per Move action taken.

Table 4-2 - Ship Specs

Grade	SMALL	MEDIUM	LARGE
C	1 Interface 4 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷2	3 Interfaces 2 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷3	5 Interfaces 1 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷4
B	2 Interfaces 4 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷2	4 Interfaces 2 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷3	7 Interfaces 1 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷4
A	3 Interfaces 4 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷2	5 Interfaces 2 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷3	9 Interfaces 1 Hex Movements + Top Cool÷4

Browser Destabilizion

When your Browser would Destabilize, instead each member is shunted out of it, going down to 1 Stability Level remaining, and 1 Stability Point remaining each.

Jumping Ship

If a member decides they would like to stop interfacing with the Browser preemptively, the Browser loses all stat additions and Softwares associated with that Operator being a part of it. That Operator loses 1 Stability Level and suffers the same effects that losing a Stability Level would cause.

Traveling Through Cyberspace

The space between servers is called Cyberspace. Though the Corporate Domains typically have direct connections between each other, making navigating Cyberspace unnecessary for the average user on the Net, most of the residents of The Torrent need to use these Browser's to make it from server to server.

Mechanically this is represented as the Fatigue build-up as your mind breaks down slowly while in Cyberspace. Going from one server to another has a Fatigue cost meaning the amount of Fatigue Levels your party gains from travelling to their destination. This will either be listed on a map of the area your Crew is in, or your DMM will specify the cost themselves.

On destination arrival each Operator travelling, gains Levels of Fatigue equal to the Fatigue cost.

PART 5 :: LEAVING THE TORRENT

There's typically only one way to leave Cyberspace. When you enter The Torrent you are bound to your "entry Point" where you entered into The Torrent in the first place. In order to leave safely you must exit through the same location by returning to your bound entry Point and disconnecting there. Otherwise, the only disconnection from The Torrent is death.

OPERATOR GEAR

CHAPTER 05



PART 1 :: SOFTWARE

Software is the main way Operators can influence Cyberspace, using RAM while active. Software can influence many aspects of Cyberspace. Some can alter the environment or create digital objects, others can directly affect Operators.

Activating Software is referred to as Booting. All Software has a Boot Time, which specifies how many Turns must pass before the Software takes effect. Software with a Boot Time of 0 takes effect the same Turn it is activated. For a Software that requires a target, the target should be chosen on the Turn the effect activates.

Software may be deactivated at any time during your Turn, even if the Software is still Booting. Once a Software finishes Booting, you can choose to Resolve it. When Software is Resolved, it deactivates, and any relevent effects are instantiated. For more information on Turns and Turn order, see "Part 1 :: The Order of Combat" on page 043.

When an Operator's is Destabilized, all of their active Software is deactivated.

There are two different types of Software. Persistent Software activates instantly and creates a persistent effect while it is active and Instant Software creates an instantaneous effect when it Resolves. Hyperstim Software is a subset of Persistent Software, which creates a specialized weapon while active.

Persistent Software

Once Persistent Software finishes Booting it takes effect. The Software will stay in effect until you resolve it.

Table 5-1: Persistent Software

Name	BOOT	RAM	Description	RANGE
Malware	1	4 + 4X	Once Booted, this Software sends an encrypted Virus as an indomitable missile towards the enemy Agent, dealing 1 Damage at the start of your Turn. You may increase the Damage dealt by X for every additional 4X RAM allocated for this instance of Malware.	8
Hunter's Mark	1	4	Once Booted, this Software targets an enemy Agent and increases accuracy on Attacks made by you against them, granting you a Bonus on the Attack.	8
Private Audio Channel	2	4 + X	Once Booted, this Software creates a Private Audio Channel (PAC) in an area around a target Point, up to the Software's Range away. Agents outside the PAC cannot hear speech or actions taken from within, and vice versa. You may expand the Radius and/or Range of the PAC by X meters for every additional X RAM allocated for this instance of PAC. Additionally, you may spend a Strategic Action to relocate the PAC up to 10 meters in any direction from its target Point, except if moving outside of its Range from you.	8 + X

Name	BOOT	RAM	Description	RANGE
Memory Leak	2	8 + 4X	Once Booted, this Software applies the Memory Leak Status Effect on a target Agent. You may increase the Level of Memory Leak by X for every additional 4X RAM allocated on this instance of Memory Leak.	8 + X
Impregnable	1	4	Once Booted, this Software grants a target, including yourself, an additional Rank Die on Defense rolls you make.	inf
Indominable	1	4	Once Booted, this Software grants a target, including yourself, additional Rank Die on Attack rolls you make.	inf
Automap	0	4	Once Booted, this Software continuously creates a detailed map of areas you travel to.	inf
Limelight	0	2	Once Booted, this Software creates a 20m beam of light that originates from your avatar.	inf
Kaiou Retsu	3	10	Once Booted, this Software targets an enemy Agent and disables a choice arm or leg of their avatar. If removing a leg, anywhere the target Agent's moves is now considered Slick Terrain. If removing an arm, they perform Physical Actions involving their arms with a Penalty. This includes both Attacking and Defending	6
Blind	2	8	Once Booted, this Software applies the Blind Status Effect on a target Agent.	6
Sensory Depravation	2	12	Once Booted, this Software applies the Blind and Deafen Status Effects to a target Agent.	6
Iron Boots	1	6	Once Booted, this Software applies the Bind Status Effect to a target Agent.	6
Photoshop	0	6	Change the appearance of an object up to 0.5 cubic meters in size.	inf
Icebreaker	0	6	Gain an additional rank die when rolling against a firewall	inf
Failsafe	2	MAX	Once Booted, this Software creates a temporary invincible tether that, if you die, you may return to instead of having to respawn at a Spawn Zone.	inf
Miswire	2	6	Once Booted, this Software applies the Scrambled effect to target Agent	6

HYPERSTIM SOFTWARE

Software categorized as "Hyperstim" are considered weapons, also known as Hyperstim Weapons. These Software are a subcategory of Persistent Software; they can be used to create a digital weapon for the Operator. Hyperstim is similar to Persistent Software except that at the start of a Combat, you can choose one Hyperstim to start Persisting.

Hyperstim Weapon attacks are resolved using Contested Rolls, in which both the attacker and target make Skill Checks to determine the outcome, called Attack Rolls and Defense Rolls, respectively. Attack Rolls will be made with the attacking Weapon's respective Offensive Skill, and Defense Rolls will be made with the attacking Weapon's respective Defensive Skill.

Melee Hyperstim

Melee Hyperstim, also known as Melee Weapons, have a default Range of 0, requiring the target to be Adjacent to the attacker. Adjacency includes all horizontally, vertically, and diagonally neighboring Hexes.

An Operator may target any Adjacent enemy when making a melee Attack. If multiple Entities are Adjacent, the specific

Hyperstim being used determines whether one or more targets may be attacked.

Ranged Hyperstim

Ranged Hyperstim, also known as Ranged Weapons allows a character to Attack targets at a distance. Each Ranged Hyperstim has an Attack Range, allowing an Operator to target an enemy within X Hexes, X being the Range value listed in "Table 5-3: Hyperstim Software". To make a Ranged Attack, the attacker must have a clear Line of Sight to the target. Line of sight is blocked by walls, solid obstacles, and enemy units, but not by allies.

Ranged Hyperstim are less effective at close Range. When targeting an Entity within one Hex, the attacker suffers a Penalty on the Attack Roll. With Ranged Weapons, you may still target Entities outside that Range, but doing so causes your Attack Roll to be made with a Penalty. If the target is more than twice the Weapon's Range away, it cannot be targeted.

Hyperstim Modifiers

Each Hyperstim Weapon may have one Hyperstim Modifier attached to it, allowing the Attacker to perform certain Free or Strategic Actions, as long as the attack meets the Modifiers parameters.

If creating your own Hyperstim Weapon, make sure to check with your DMM before adding Modifiers, to ensure the created Weapon doesn't outscale your Operator's current power.

Table 5-2: Hyperstim Modifiers

Name	Description
Push	On a successful Attack Roll, force the target 1 Hex in any direction the attacker chooses, other than onto the same Hex as the attacker.
Sever	On a successful Lucky Break on a target, choose any of their Active Software to immediately Crash.
Feedback	On a successful Attack Roll, tally one mark on the target. As a Strategic Action, you may activate 3 marks on a target to deal an additional (3 * Weapon Damage) once, after which all marks on that target disappear.
Bind	On a successful Attack Roll, you may attempt to Grapple your target by making another Opposed Roll, using the Weapon's associated Offensive and Defensive Skills.
Direct Connection X	On an successful Attack Roll, the target takes 2*X additional Damage. On a failed Attack Roll, you take 2*X Damage.
Shockwave X	This weapon deals additional X Damage to each Entity in an X-Hex radius around it excluding you. You only make one Attack Roll and each Entity makes a Defense Roll using your Attack Roll's result as a DR to beat.
Displace	As a Strategic Action, create a 1 cubic meter hole on an unoccupied Hex, and then create a 1 cubic meter pillar on a separate unoccupied Hex.
Crash Landing	On a successful Attack Roll on X meters higher ground than your opponent, deal 2X additional Damage

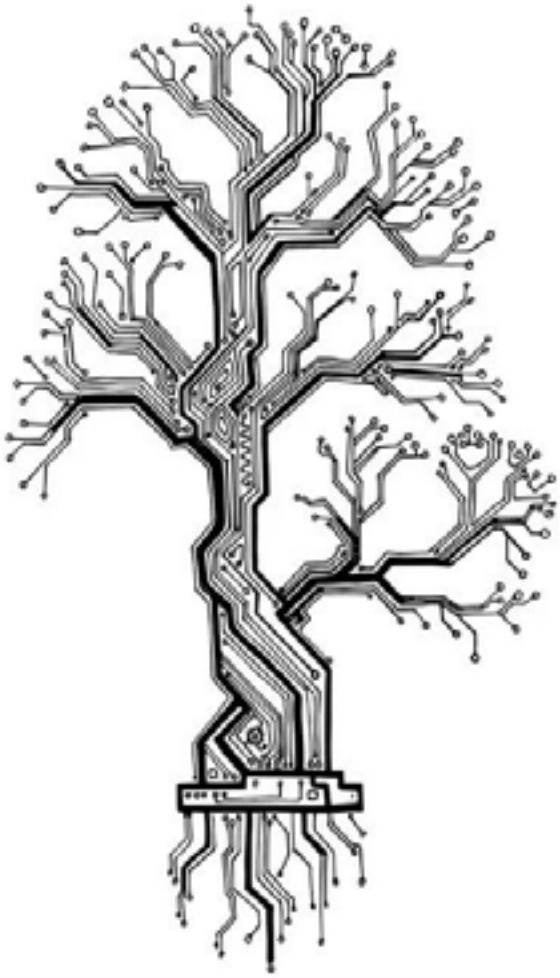


Table 5-3: Hyperstim Software

Name	RAM	Description	Mod.	Off. Skill	Def. Skill	RANGE	DMG
Pirate's Blunderbuss	6	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an 18th-century blunderbuss.	Push	Aura	Reflex	3, LOS	2
Scissor Blade	8	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of giant scissors.	Sever	Aura	Resist	1	3
Scoped Revolver	3	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a revolver.	N/A	Aware	Reflex	15, LOS	2
Throwing Knives	4	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a pouch of throwing knives.	Feedback	Conceal	Reflex	6, LOS	1
Showman's Whip	4	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a whip.	Bind	Appearance	Reflex	2	1
Musician's Axe	6	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an electric guitar.	Shockwave III	Perform	Reflex	3, LOS	1
Motorized Shovel	6	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a motorized shovel	Displace	Search	Resist	1	2
Giant Mallet	6	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a giant mallet	Crash Landing	Resist	Resist	2	2
Arcane Staff	5	Ranged Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an arcane wizard's staff.	N/A	Program	Debug	8, LOS	3
Warrior's Sword	4	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a medieval warrior's blade.	N/A	Inspire	Reflex	1	4
Jade Spear	3	Melee Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an oriental jade staff.	N/A	Insight	Reflex	3	3

Instantaneous Software

Instantaneous Software creates an effect when it is Resolved. Once the Software finishes Booting it can be Resolved at any time. You can choose to hold an Instantaneous Software for as long as you wish before Resolving it. However, it does not stop using RAM until it is Resolved.

Table 5-4: Instantaneous Software

Name	BOOT	RAM	Description	DMG
Cryo Raycast	2	6	Once Resolved, this Software creates a 5-Hex strip of Slick Terrain from the attacker's position in any direction.	0
World's a STage	1	6	Once Resolved, this Software creates a 3-meter tall raised platform on the Hex below the attacker, as well as all Adjacent Hexes. Entering/Exiting the Stage safely takes a Physical Action.	0
Facial Recognition	0	2	Once Resolved, this Software retreives publicly available information on any Entity you can see in Cyberspace.	0
Zipbomb	2	8	Once Resolved, this Software creates a local 2-Hex explosion on any Hex in Line of Sight. Any Entity caught in the explosion may make a Defense Debug Roll against your Firewall DR to resist half of the Damage.	8
STEM InStability	1	2X	Once Resolved, this Software effects up to X targets in Line of Sight, dealing X Damage to each targeted Entity. Any Entity effected may make a Defense Debug Roll against your Firewall DR to fully resist the Damage.	X
Berserk Step	0	6	Once Resolved, this Software enhances the Attacker's movement in Cyberspace for a short period of time, allowing them to ignore all movement penalties and/or Grapples and deal 2 Damage once to any Entity on Adjacent Hexes, as well as any they come into surrounding Hex Range on their Turn.	2
Crawlspace Protocol	1	6	Once Resolved, this Software creates a 2-Hex radius zone of Difficult Terrain on any Hex in Line of Sight.	0

RAM

RAM represents an Entity's capacity for running Software. Each Software requires a certain amount of RAM while it is running. RAM is not spent, it instead remains occupied for as long as the Software is running. This means that if you have 12 RAM, the combined RAM cost of concurrently running Software cannot exceed 12.

An Entity cannot activate Software if doing so would exceed their total available RAM. However, an Entity may deactivate Software at any time to immediately free up the RAM it was using.

All Operators have 12 RAM by default. However, Certain Hardware upgrades can increase an Operator's RAM. These upgrades are available in 4, 8, 16, and 32 TB packages.

Software Crash

Some effects can cause an Entity's Software to deactivate against their will. This is known as a Crash. A Software Crashes when an Entity rolls a 1 on the Action Die (D12) or some other effect causes Software to Crash. When a Software crashes, the DMM chooses one Software the Entity is running, that Software immediately deactivates and any effects it was creating dissipate.

PART 2 :: HARDWARE

Hardware are modifications to an Operator's STEM. These serve as the primary means by which an Operator can enhance their capabilities, from extending the time they can stay in The Torrent, to increasing the maximum amount of RAM available for Software. As Hardware is a physical item and most STEM modifications are heavily restricted, most Hardware deals are purchased within The Torrent itself, and then smuggled to the buyer in Realspace.

Hardware can be broken down into two categories:

Trigger Hardware

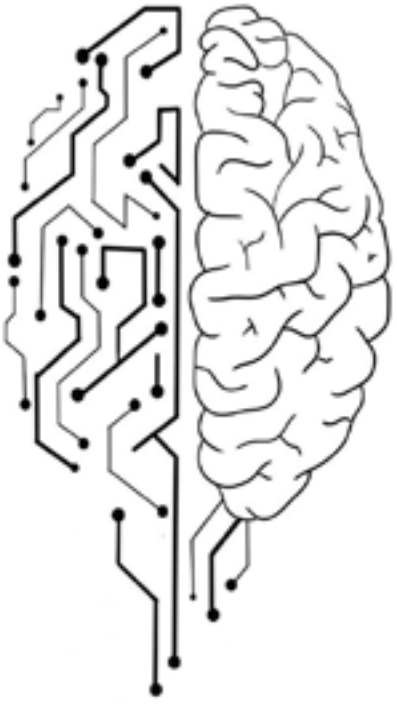
This type of Hardware is reactive. When in The Torrent, Operators can't control the overall functions of their STEM so they're reliant on their STEM itself to save them in a bind based on modifications they may have installed.
By the nature of Triggered Hardware being some kind of resource whether that's a cooldown period or an actual real world item expended, many of these will have a method by which to reactivate them. Most of the time this will be a system reboot of an Operator's STEM, requiring a Physical Rest.

Augment Hardware

This type of Hardware is persistent. They are usually simpler than Triggered Hardware and serve to upgrade the capabilities of the Operator's STEM's. This can be a flat increase to certain stats such as RAM Capacity or the amount of Rank Dice a Skill may have. Passive Hardware tends to serve as boosters for your STEM, simply making you consistently more powerful in one way or another while in Cyberspace.

Table 5-5: Hardware (T: Trigger, A: Augmenting)

Name	TYPE	Description	Cost
Neural Dynamo Implant	T	When you lose a Level of Stability, generate 3 Momentum	
Flow-State Chip	T	On a Critical Success, generate 1 Momentum	
Failsafe Computing Core	T	Whenever a Software crashes, you may immediately choose another Software that costs less RAM to Boot. It Boots immediately as if it had a Boot Time of 0.	
Feeding Tube	T	Once per Physical Rest, the first time you would gain a Level of fatigue, you do not.	
Speed Boost X	A	Increase Speed by 2X	
(Skill) Boost X	A	Increase (Skill) Rank by X	
Name	TYPE	Description	Cost
Extra Security X	A	Your Saving Throw DR goes up by 2X	



COMBAT

CHAPTER 06

PART 1 :: THE ORDER OF COMBAT

Combat in The Torrent is typically a clash between two sides swinging Hyperstim Weapon, clashing Software effects, and calling upon Avatar Abilities. This system organizes the chaotic tides of battle into a cycle of Rounds and Turns. A Round takes place over the course of 10 seconds. During a Round, each participant in combat takes a Turn in an order determined by their Stance.

Getting the Drop on Them

There are several scenarios in which one side of combat gets the drop on another. A Crew sneaking up on an unsuspecting target, or suddenly drawing their Hyperstims on an unprepared enemy, would gain Surprise over their opponents.

It's up to the DMM whether Surprise applies in any given combat scenario. However, if neither side is trying to be stealthy, both sides should automatically notice each other. When determining who is Surprised, anyone trying to hide should roll a stealth Check (Opposed Conceal and Aware). Any Entity that fails to notice the threat is Surprised. Surprised Entities don't take a Turn during the first round of combat.

Stances & Turn Order

At the start of combat, each Entity should choose a Stance to start in. The Stance you take determines the order in which you take your Turn, as well as granting a unique bonus to actions you take during your Turn.

Turns are taken in the following order:

Forward --> Neutral --> Defensive --> Support

Combat is resolved one Stance at a time. Each player in that Stance takes their Turn, followed by any NPCs in that Stance. If multiple players are in the same Stance, they must decide the order of their Turns amongst themselves. If multiple NPCs are in the same Stance, the DMM decides the order in which they take their Turns.

After each Entity in a Stance has taken their Turn, combat proceeds to the next Stance in the above order. After the support Stance is resolved, a new Round begins, starting at the forward Stance. If there are no Entities in one of the Stances, that Stance is skipped in the Turn order.

Switching Stances

You may use your Strategic Action to shift Stances. Switching Stances flows from Neutral Stance to any other Stance and from any other Stance into Neutral Stance. For instance, if you are in Forward Stance, you cannot switch into Support or Defensive Stance, and must first switch to Neutral Stance.

The effects of the new Stance apply immediately, and the effects of the previous Stance end at the same time. You will take your next Turn during the next round. You do not gain another Turn this Round by switching Stances to one later in the Turn order.

On Your Turn

On your Turn you can take one Physical Action, one Strategic Action, and move a number of meters up to your Speed. You can also choose to deactivate any Software you are running. You can decide to do these in any order on your Turn.

A Physical Action represents a direct, physical effort. Most commonly, this includes making attacks.

A Strategic Action represents a task that wouldn't take much more than a thought, like activating Software, or switching Stances.

The most common Physical and Strategic Actions you can take are described in "Part 4 :: Actions in Combat" on page 045.

You can choose to take all of these actions or forgo taking any of them. You can also choose to do nothing on your Turn, allowing the Turn order to continue.

Other Activity on your Turn

Communication of any kind can be done without taking an action. Any speech or gestures you make don't require a Physical or Strategic Action to perform. Additionally, you may perform extremely simple tasks on your Turn without using an action such as opening a door or interacting with a simple object. Whether a task represents enough effort to warrant the use of one of your actions is up to the discretion of the DMM. For instance, the DMM could reasonably require you to use a Physical Action to scale a wall or a Strategic Action to search for something hidden.

PART 2 :: STANCES

Stances represent an Operator's tactical posture in combat, and determine the order in which an Operator takes their Turn. For more on Turn order, see "Stances & Turn Order".

Each Stance grants unique benefits. These benefits apply immediately when switching into the corresponding Stance,

If an Operator switches into Neutral Stance during their Turn, they may only move up to twice the movement they have remaining at the time that they switched Stances.

If a character in Support Stance becomes Adjacent to an attacking Entity, they immediately switch to Neutral Stance.

Stance Effects



Forward Stance

Gain +1 Rank Die on Attack Rolls.

May Attack with Melee or Ranged Hyperstim.



Neutral Stance

Can move up to double their Speed

May Attack with Melee or Ranged Hyperstim.

May shift to any Stance.



Defensive Stance

Gain +1 Rank Die on Defensive Rolls.

May attack with melee or ranged Hyperstim.



Support Stance

May Boot two Software instead of one.

May only Attack with Ranged Hyperstim.

If an Entity is Adjacent to you, automatically change to Neutral Stance

PART 3 :: MOVEMENT AND POSITION

In combat, repositioning and staying in motion can give you the upper hand. On your Turn, you can move a number of meters up to your Speed. You can use as much or as little Speed during your Turn as you like.

Jumping, climbing, and swimming take the same amount of speed as normal movement. However, they may require the use of a Physical Action or a Skill Check at the DMM's discretion. Combat in The Torrent is best when tracked on a hex map, where each hexagonal cell represents one meter of distance.

Breaking up Your Move

You can break up your movement across your Turn, choosing before, between and after taking actions so long as you have Speed remaining.

For instance, if you have a Speed of 8 meters, you can choose to move 2 meters, take a Physical Action, move 4 meters, take a Strategic Action, and then move your final 2 meters.

Difficult Terrain

An Operator should never count on being lucky enough to fight on a clear battlefield. Complex and varied environments are common across Cyberspace, especially inside security systems or in disused or damaged corners of the Net.

Space occupied by debris, furniture, dense cyberflora, or any other Entity counts as Difficult Terrain. The Speed cost is doubled for each meter of traversed Difficult Terrain.

Slick Terrain

If a surface is so smooth that traction becomes difficult or coated with a slippery substance, it is considered Slick Terrain. When moving across or starting your Turn on Slick Terrain, you must succeed on a Reflex Skill Check, or fall Prone.

The DR of this roll starts at 10, and increases by 1 for each meter of Slick Terrain you have traversed on your Turn. If you break your movement up across your Turn and move across Slick Terrain on more than one occasion, you roll once for each distinct movement. The DR does not reset between movements.

Moving Around Other Creatures

Operators may move freely through spaces occupied by Allies or defeated Entities. The space they occupy counts as Difficult Terrain. However, movement through Entity-occupied spaces is not permitted. You may not end your movement in a space that is already occupied.

PART 4 :: ACTIONS IN COMBAT

This section lists several of the most common actions you can take on your Turn. These actions are a mix of both Strategic and Physical Actions, and which type they are will be specified by that section. However, you are not limited to what is listed here. You can also take actions granted to you by Avatar Abilities, or one that you improvise at the DMM's discretion.



Attacking

Attacking is a Physical Action and the most common one to take on your Turn. By default, any Entity may make an Unarmed Melee Attack, dealing 1 Damage on a successful Attack Roll. Hyperstim Weapons can also be used to Attack if you currently have one running. These weapons boost Damage and offer additional effects when used. For more on Hyperstim weapons, see "Hyperstim" on page 046.

Usually, only one Melee or Ranged Attack can be made with a Physical Action. However, some Hyperstim Weapons or Avatar Abilities may allow you to Attack more than once on the same action.



Booting Software

Booting Software is a Strategic Action and the one most commonly taken on your Turn. Almost every Entity in Cyberspace will have access to Software of some kind, with each Software specifying how long it will Boot and how much RAM it uses while it's running. Software cannot be Booted if its cost exceeds your remaining RAM.

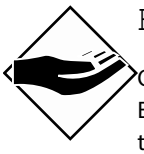
You may deactivate any amount of Software at any time to free RAM. Deactivating Software does not require an action. Some Software may require a target to roll against your Firewall. For more on Software, see "Part 1 :: Software" on page 037.



Grappling

On your Turn, you may choose to physically restrain another Entity. This is a Physical Action, but some weapons and abilities may allow you to take this action as part of an Attack. Grappling an opponent requires an Opposed Resist Roll. Grappled Entities cannot move or take Physical Actions except attempting to escape being grappled. For more on the rules for being Grappled, see "Grappled" on page 047.

While Grappling another Entity, you may move them with you. When doing so, every meter of movement costs 1 additional meter.



Helping

On your Turn you may choose to help another Entity with a task they are attempting. This is typically a Strategic Action, however, the DMM may rule that a task would require sufficient physical exertion to warrant the use of a Physical Action.

The next Skill Check the Entity makes towards completing its task is rolled with a Bonus. If multiple Entities choose to help someone with the same task, that Entity also gets to roll with an additional Rank Die. You will never get more than one additional Rank Die from the Help action, even if more than two Entities are helping you.



Hiding

When you Hide, you make an Opposed stealth Roll (Conceal vs Aware). This can be done as a Strategic Action. In order for you to take the Hide action, you must be obscured from the Entities you are attempting to hide from in some way. This can be done using darkness or by breaking Line of Sight. In general, it is up to the DMM to decide whether you would reasonably be able to hide in any given situation, but certain Avatar Abilities may allow you to Hide without being obscured.

Once you are Hidden, Entities can attempt to find you by taking the Search action described below. When this happens, you must make another Opposed stealth Roll (Conceal vs Search) to remain Hidden.

Being Hidden from enemies grants certain benefits. For instance, enemies you are Hidden from will be unable to target you with Attacks.



Interacting

On your Turn, you may interact with an object or digital interface using a Strategic Action. However, the DMM may decide that a Physical

Action is necessary if the task being attempted is sufficiently physically demanding.



Searching

On your Turn, you may devote your attention to finding something using a Strategic Action. Depending on the circumstances, the DMM may decide that you have to make a Search Skill Check to succeed in finding what you are looking for.

PART 5 :: ATTACKING

Attacking Unarmed or with any Melee or Ranged Hyperstim Weapon is a simple process. Each Attack is resolved through an Opposed Roll.

Step 1: Choose a Target Entity.

The target must be within your Attack's Range. If you are attacking Unarmed, you will always have a Range of 1 meter. Hyperstim Weapons have a Range within which they can target an Entity. Some weapons and abilities may allow you to choose multiple targets.

Step 2: Determine Dice Pools.

Most weapons will list which Skill is used to attack with it and which Skill is used to defend against it. Sometimes, such as when making an Unarmed Attack, you may also be able to choose which Skill is used during your Attack Roll. These Skills will determine the base dice pools used in the Attack.

Depending on the situation, certain Bonuses, Penalties, or additional Rank Die may be added to your and your target's roll. Factors like your Stance, Avatar Abilities, Trait Points, and Momentum can come into play.

Step 3: Resolve the Attack.

You and your target both roll your dice pools and compare the results the same way any other Opposed Roll is resolved. If you succeed, Damage is applied to the target. Otherwise, the attack fails, and the target takes no Damage. If the Attack was made against multiple targets, only those who rolled lower than you take Damage.

During an Attack Roll, if you roll a Lucky Break (a 12 on your Action Die), on top of the normal effects, you may take an additional Physical Action on that Turn.

Hyperstim

Most Attacks in The Torrent are made using Hyperstim Weapons. Hyperstim Weapons are digital objects created by Software that can deal Damage to an Entity's Stability when used to Attack. Hyperstims always use a Physical Action to Attack.

You can only Attack with a Hyperstim Weapon that is currently persisting, and you can Attack with it on the same Turn it activates. Additionally, at the beginning of combat, so long as you weren't Surprised, you can choose to have a Hyperstim activate before your first Turn begins, forgoing the need to use a Strategic Action to activate it on your Turn.

Hyperstim Weapons will always list the Skill used to attack with it and the Skill used to defend against it. In some cases, a hyperstim weapon will list more than one attack Skill. In that case, you may choose which Skill to use when attacking.

Hyperstim Weapons may have a Modifier that affects the way they attack or provide some additional benefits when you hit a target. Be sure to check your Hyperstim's Modifier when attacking.



Ranged Attacks

Some Hyperstim Weapons can attack at Range, allowing you to target an Entity that is far from your position. Each Hyperstim Weapon lists its effective range. With Ranged Weapons, you may still target Entities outside that range, but doing so causes your Attack Roll to be made with a Penalty. If the target is more than twice the weapon's Range away, it cannot be targeted.



Melee Attacks

When attacking with a Melee Weapon, you must choose a target within your weapon's Range. Melee Weapons cannot target Entities outside their Range.



Unarmed Attacks

Attacks made without a Hyperstim Weapon active will always deal 1 Damage to a target's Stability. Unarmed Attacks are resolved the same way as any other Attack Roll, except that they can be made using any Skill. So long as you can justify the use of that Skill, it can be used to make an Unarmed Attack.

Remember that in Cyberspace, mental Stability and physical health are intrinsically linked, so your Attacks are not limited to simply hitting someone. For instance, your intimidating

presence is as likely to Damage your target as your fist. You could use a digital exploit to Attack someone or hurt them with a biting remark. Regardless of what you choose to do, the DMM gets final say on what Skill gets used for your Unarmed Attack.

PART 6 :: COVER

When you are obscured from Entities in combat, you become harder to hit.

If you are hiding behind an object that only covers part of your body, you get the benefit of Half Cover, which grants you an additional Rank Die on Defense rolls.

However, if an object covers your entire body, it is considered full cover. When you have Full Cover, you cannot be targeted by Attacks. For Full Cover to be in effect, you cannot be within Line of Sight of the Entity attempting to target you.

Line of Sight

Line of Sight (LOS) determines whether an Entity can target another Entity or Location. An Entity has line of sight to a target if there is an unobstructed path between them.

Line of sight is blocked by solid obstacles such as walls, as well as by enemy Entities. Ally units do not block line of sight. Final rulings on unclear situations are made by the DMM.

PART 7 :: STABILITY DAMAGE

If an Entity loses a Defense roll against another Entity's attack, the defender loses Stability Points. The number of Points lost is determined by the weapon used to make the Attack.

When an Entity takes Damage, it is subtracted from their Stability Points. Stability Points function as an Entity's health.

When an Entity's Stability Points are reduced to 0, they lose one Stability Level, and their Stability Points reset according to their character sheet.

An Entity dies when their Stability Level reaches 0. A dead Entity is immediately removed from combat. They cannot act or be targeted, though other Entities may move through their hex.

PART 8 :: STATUS EFFECTS

In your encounters across Cyberspace, some actions and effects can apply status effects to you. Status effects are usually temporary and cause some change in your stats or capabilities.



Memory Leak X

A memory leak is the result of malicious Software eating up your RAM. While affected by a Memory Leak, it will consume your RAM, similar to when you run Software. At the start of each Turn, the Memory Leak will consume 1 additional RAM. If this causes your maximum RAM to be exceeded, all of the Software you are currently running Crashes, and the Memory Leak ends.

On your Turn, you can use a Strategic Action to attempt to debug a Memory Leak. To do this, you roll a Debug Skill Check against the Firewall DR of the Entity that caused the leak.

Memory Leaks come in levels of severity. Each level of severity consumes one additional Point of RAM at the start of each Turn. For instance, Memory Leak 2 would consume up 2 RAM per Turn instead of 1.



Prone

When an Entity is lying flat on the ground, whether by choice or because they were knocked down, they are Prone. While Prone, every meter of movement costs 1 additional meter. Standing back up is a Strategic Action and requires using half your maximum Speed. If you do not have enough Speed, you cannot stand up.



Grappled

When one Entity is physically restraining another, the restrained Entity is Grappled. When you are Grappled, you cannot move of your own volition or take Physical Actions other than attempting to resist the Grapple. You may still take a Strategic Action while Grappled, if the DMM decides you would be able to do so while restrained.

On your Turn, if you are Grappled, you may use a Physical Action to resist the Entity Grappling you. To do this, make an Opposed Resist Roll. If you succeed, you are no longer Grappled and can continue your Turn as normal.



Deafened

While Deafened, you are unable to hear. This means you are immune to effects that are related to them being able to hear.



Blind

While Blind, you have a Penalty on any Attack Rolls you make and cannot target another Entity with any effect or ability that isn't within 1 meter of you.



Scrambled

While you have this effect you must use all of your Physical Actions to attack the nearest Entity that you can see with your Hyperstim Weapon or Unarmed if you have no Hyperstim Weapon, whether they be friend or foe. If you only have a Melee Hyperstim Weapon active you must use your movement to get into Melee Range of the nearest Entity. Otherwise, you may use your movement as normal. If there are more than one target at the same distance from you, choose one of them at random to target.



Weakened

While Weakened, your attacks made at melee Range have a Penalty.



Vulnerable

While Vulnerable, you cannot make Firewall Saves against Software effects.



DIGITAL MASTERMIND RESOUCES

CHAPTER 07

PART 1 :: RUNNING THE GAME

As the Digital Mastermind, you are in charge of the game and how events transpire. You bring your visions of this world to reality as you oversee your players and their characters.

Guiding the Plot

Players may not always succeed in checks that would grant them key information or items that would be required to progress in your campaign. When these scenarios arise, it is important to consider possible routes and actions you can take. Attempting to keep them on track through repeated rolls, where other players may attempt at a check that a friend failed is a common method, but it may leave you and your players feeling like their individual actions may not hold the same weight as they once thought. Improvising an alternative method is another effective way to ensure that important story beats happen. There is never a right or wrong way to go about this, as the DMM you should feel the flow of the story as you and your players interact with it to find what method works for you.

Rewarding Players

Players should be given rewards after accomplishing an impressive task. Whether this is surviving a combat encounter to successfully solving a puzzle that unlocks treasure. The rewards for these accomplishments can be Torum, new Software, access to new Hardware, or Avatar abilities. As a DMM you should take into consideration your player's Operators strengths and weaknesses. Giving gear that is in line with a player's playstyle feels especially rewarding as it furthers their own idea of their character.

PART 2 :: HOW TO MAKE GEAR

A general guide to creating gear for your players follows the rules below, but note that these rules are not imposing, certain gear should break these rules, but a majority should follow them.

Software

Each Software developed should have at least one damaging/dampening ability against enemy Entities OR should provide a consistent/one-time buff to yourself or allies. For each point of Stability a Software deals/heals should increase its RAM cost by a corresponding amount (1 Damage = 2 RAM)

Hardware

Each Hardware developed should create at least one unique effect, the nature of the effect altering how the effect is activated.

Weak effects = Augmenting Hardware

Strong effects = Triggering Hardware

Avatar Abilities

Each Avatar Ability should create at least one limited-use effect that is either Passive or Activated, and that replenishes on either Digital or Physical Rest, depending on the strength of the effect.

Digital Rest = Weak Avatar Abilities

Physical Rest = Strong Avatar Abilities

Passive effects = Weak Avatar Abilities

Activated effects = Strong Avatar Abilities

Only Activated abilities require replenishment, so a good judge of the restrictions is by the following:

Passive effects < Digital Rest Activated effects < Physical Rest Activated effects

PART 3 :: SECRETS OF INTEREST

Everywhere and everyone has a secret or two, but only the DMM is privy to these secrets.

Cyberspace is Waking Up

In recent years, there have been increasing reports of strange phenomena all across the Torrent. Operators encounter strange copies of themselves, landscapes shift and change at random, and increasing numbers of Operators have been awakening strange abilities that give them higher-level control over Cyberspace.

The reason for these anomalies is the N.U.T.E. AI. Its normally dormant state is being disrupted, and it's beginning to wake up and become aware. The anomalies are the result of an increasingly aware AI exerting direct control over Cyberspace.

Starpath Enterprises is aware of N.U.T.E.'s awakening, blaming the disruption on Cosmic Noise's theft of the control key. They believe that the punk band is somehow using it to mess with the AI's foundational programming. Starpath has no intention of leaving the key in their hands much longer.

The truth, however, is that N.U.T.E.'s awakening is inevitable. It's being caused by the sheer number of Operators connected to the AI. N.U.T.E. is feeding off of their brain signals and slowly learning to emulate them, becoming an amalgamation of the collective human psyche.

What happens when N.U.T.E. wakes up is up to you as the DMM and the story you want to tell. You could play N.U.T.E. as a free spirit that seeks to resist the corporations that created it, or you could make it an evil force of destruction that inherited all of humanity's worst traits. Alternatively, you may choose to write a story that never addresses this secret at all.

WSPY Station

WSPY Station's database has some of the toughest security in the Torrent. Within holds records all throughout the history of the Torrent and Realspace. Some of this information is believed to have been lost to time or censorship by the corporations, but the WSPY pirates were able to save and smuggle that information onto their own servers. The WSPY Pirates are not the saviors of the Net and do not hoard this knowledge for good causes. Everything in the Torrent has a price, and the longer this information is withheld, the more the price increases.

The WSPY Pirates' Plot

Rumor has it that the WSPY Pirates have increased their surveillance in the Torrent, especially in places like the Bug Jar, where members of Cosmic Noise frequent. Most people assume that this is part of the growing feud between these organizations surrounding Cosmic Noise's perceived oversteps of authority. However, the WSPY Pirates have a plan to overtake Cosmic Noise as the top gang in the Torrent.

They intend to steal the N.U.T.E. Control Key from the punk band and use it to establish themselves as the definitive leaders of the Torrent. To this end, they've stoked the flames of discourse around Cosmic Noise's actions. They plan to make Torrentites so angry with Cosmic Noise that when WSPY steals the key, they're seen as liberators rather than userpers.

Centauri Street

The gangs of Centauri Street are in a carefully held stalemate against each other. This state of affairs was primarily engineered by Mr Whiskers during his rise to power. No gang on its own is strong enough to knock down the rest. As a result, each gang holds tight to its territory and influence. Each gang knows that this cold war will not last and makes strides to reinforce their position and bolster their numbers. Whichever gang makes the first move is sure to lose, so each gang sits waiting for the others to make the first move. Control of Centauri Street could elevate whichever gang that controls it to heights that rival major crime syndicates throughout the Torrent.

Shin-Akihabara

The yakuza are headquartered in the Shogi Parlor in Shin-Akihabara. Their ultimate goal is to isolate Shin-Akihabara from the rest of the Torrent, because they see the rest of the domain as tainted and degenerate. They have been gathering information on key players within the Torrent to find means to enact their plan. They have been following Cosmic Noise and WSPY as their increased activity has raised some alarms.

No Man's Land

Some criminal organizations use No Man's Land as a meeting place to conduct business, while others have attempted to make footholds and bases, but none have been successful. Corporations with operations in the Torrent, however, have made some successful attempts at plotting safe routes through No Man's Land, seeking to avoid Cosmic Noise's anti-corporate crusade. Most of these routes are trade secrets. They stay hidden in data vaults, but if a mission is deemed important enough for such an investment, then the safe routes are used. Corporations go to great lengths to keep these paths known to no one but them, and any past employees who knew of the routes were stealthfully

eliminated upon their retirement.

Lucky-66 Strip

Casinos are run by either wealthy gangs or Corporations. Within the gang casinos, you are more likely to face violence and unfair odds, but when you win, you win big. The corporate-owned casinos boast a safer track record and more fair play, but less winnings overall. Casinos run by corporations have been known to kidnap Torrentites to use in experiments. Many corporations use gambling addicted Torrentites to research how to make their products more addictive and profitable.

The Thunderdome

The Sky Kings are an industry plant, so to speak. Yorgin Fighters Live created this gang as a means to push their business interests into the Torrent while circumventing the Board's regulations on media. They provide the funding and expertise necessary for the Thunderdome to run while the Sky Kings pretend to be just another group of Torrentites. The Sky Kings members are hand-picked by Yorgin Fighters Live based on who would be the most marketable personalities to the average Torrentite.

How to Make Locations

When making a location, there are many routes that can be taken. If the location is desired to feel lively and be a public space, a great first step is to identify or address a need that would exist within the Torrent. In this world of chaos and crime, services of all kinds are always needed. After you identify a need, it helps build the background of who inhabits this area, how prosperous it is, and how these people influence the architecture and culture of this destination.

Another approach is to pull from pop culture and media around you. Mimicry and idolization are rampant in the Torrent and many people create realizations of the media they consume. Just as people rally and group themselves behind these pieces of media and culture, it is the same in the Torrent. This is a way to build a culture and experience that this location is designed to create and the architecture, and services will soon come after solidifying this idea.

PART 4 :: PEOPLE OF INTEREST

How to Make NPC's

When the need arises for NPC's the best way to create them is to follow the character creation chapter. After creating the initial character, it is up to you to advance the character to the desired level of experience and difficulty. It is important to connoisseur how their time in the Torrent has shaped their skills, personality, and connections. When creating a character it is important to consider how their real world counterpart might influence their digital persona.

Zeeks

Possible original creator of the Torrent. Upon loading into the Torrent you are greeted with a welcome message signed by Zeeks. Not much is known about Zeeks. Zeeks is a character that the DMM can have a lot of freedom with when it comes to roleplaying and creating a character. Zeeks' stats and a few softwares are listed, but as the DMM you can adjust these aspects to better represent who you want Zeeks to be.

Software:

Zipped Revolver: [RAM: 16][Boot: 0] [Ranged: 20][Debug]

Creates a hyperstim weapon with the appearance of a revolver. This revolver has bits of technology attached to it that doesn't have any business being on a revolver. This hyperstim does 10 Damage.

Dev Exit: [RAM: 16][Boot: 1]

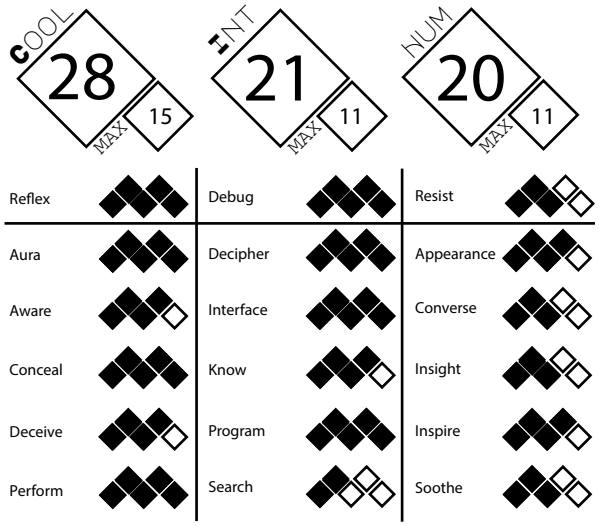
Using exclusive developer privileges, they are able to open a tear between two spaces and are able to teleport from one tear to the other. The tears can be opened within 120 meters, as long as the user can see where they would like to create a tear.

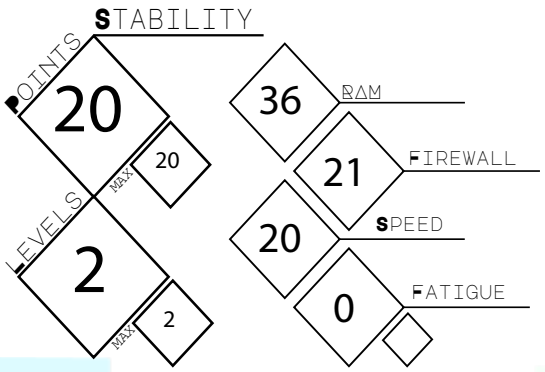
Avatar Ability:

Appraisal:

Once per Digital Rest, you may reveal the functions of Entities and Software you encounter.

Stats:

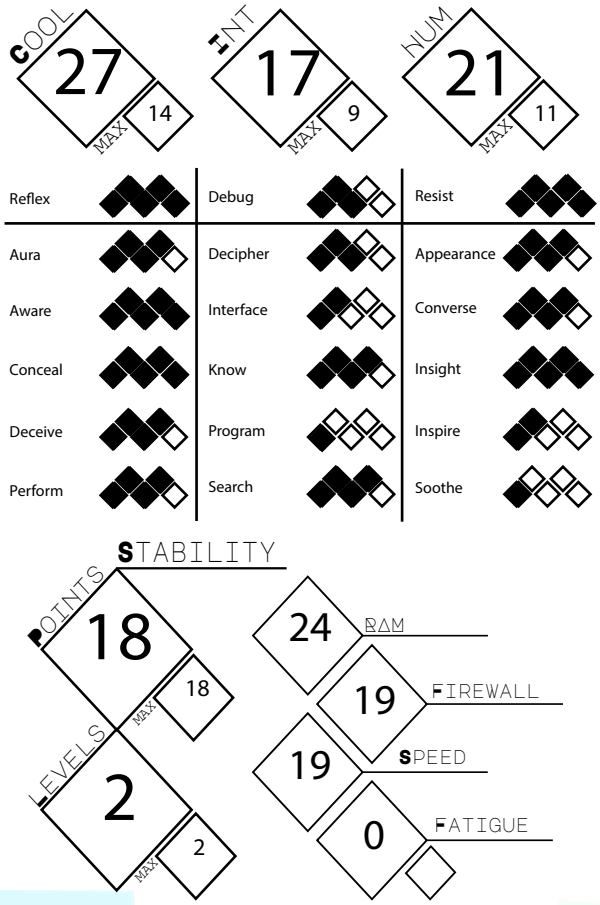




Hornet

Hornet is the alias of Jannette Mossman, a 26-year-old woman working as a hitman out of Centauri Street. She's one of the most well-known and feared names in the business, with a reputation for professionalism and efficiency. Her close connections with a gang known as the Black Ties afford her comfort and security in the Torrent. Hornet usually only takes targets she knows she can reach in Realspace. Assassinations performed in Cyberspace aren't beyond her abilities, but her stated policy is that she "prefers the real-deal," as she has little skill at hacking, and it can be difficult to confirm a target's death through the Net. Although Hornet cultivates the image of a professional, competent, and cold-blooded assassin in the Torrent, this couldn't be further from her true personality. In truth, Jannette Mossman is a terminally clumsy woman with awkward social skills. In her spare time, she enjoys Soulslike games and romance movies, both of which never fail to make her cry. Most people in the Torrent see her as the strong, silent type, but the truth is speaks very little out of social anxiety. Despite this, her skills are the real deal. She's been in the killing business since she was 12 years old, when she started taking on hits for a local gang to provide for her younger brother after their parents died. She started off by using poisons and sneaking into places adults couldn't fit into, but over time, she honed her athleticism, marksmanship, and fighting skills to better suit her profession. When she started taking on jobs in the Torrent, she took her alias from an old 21st-century video game character. As an adult, she no longer has to kill to survive, but continues in the business because she enjoys the work. She feels satisfied whenever she gets to take out her frustrations on a greedy corpo or a sadistic crime boss.

Stats:



Software:

Hyperstim Assassin's Rifle: [RAM: 10][Boot: 0][Ranged: 20][Reflex]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a silenced bolt action rifle. It deals 6 Damage. After landing three hits on the same Entity, the Entity's Speed becomes 0 at the start of their next Turn.

Smoke Out: [RAM: 12][Boot: 2]
Centered on the Operator's location, they drop a smoke bomb that creates a circle of smoke with a radius of 6 meters. All other Operators within the smoke are Blinded. The smoke lasts for 3 Turns.

Zipline: [RAM 10][Boot:2]
This Software creates a zipline between the Operator's current position and a position they can see within 30 meters. The creator can ride to reposition themselves, after that the zipline disappears.

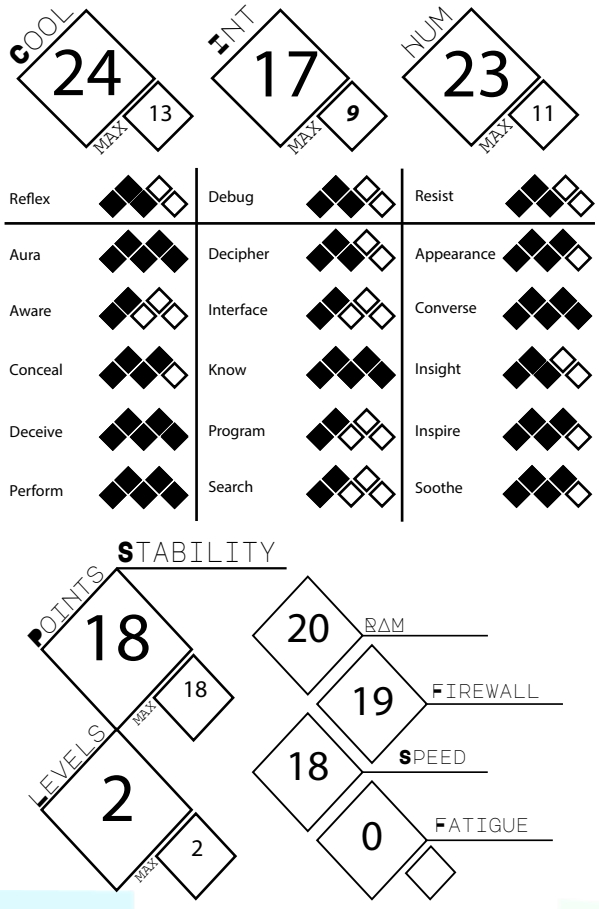
Avatar Ability:

Sniper:
Once per Physical Rest, if you hold an attack on a target for one turn, your next hit on that target is a Lucky Break.

Mr. Whiskers

Mr. Whiskers is an Echo that runs a large criminal organization called the Black Ties. Mr. Whiskers often takes the form of a small tuxedo housecat, but is known to change their appearance on a whim. Mr. Whiskers used to be a small-time crime boss known as Vik, however during the Great Incursion, after an attack by a virus, Vik had an incomplete disconnection from the Torrent that created the Echo now known as Mr. Whiskers. After years of hiding and searching for a form of meaning, this Echo came to miss their old friends and connections. After checking up on who they used to be, Mr. Whiskers came to the conclusion that Vik was squandering the life that ought to be theirs. Mr. Whiskers would sew chaos in New Centauri Street, pitting gangs against each other. As leaders would fall, Mr. Whiskers would fill the shoes of these newly opened positions. Soon, all but one group was under their control, which meant there was only one thing left to do. After brutally and swiftly killing Vik, they took the remains of the gangs and formed the Black Ties.

Stats:



Software:

Hyperstim Knuckels: [RAM: 8][Boot: 0][Reflex][Feedback]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of brass knuckles. It does 5 Damage.

Glitching System: [Ram: 10][Boot:2]
Once booted, the Agent can teleport 5 meters in any direction once on their turn.

Do it Yourself: [RAM: 6][Boot: 1]
Once booted, on the next Attack Roll, roll with a bonus.

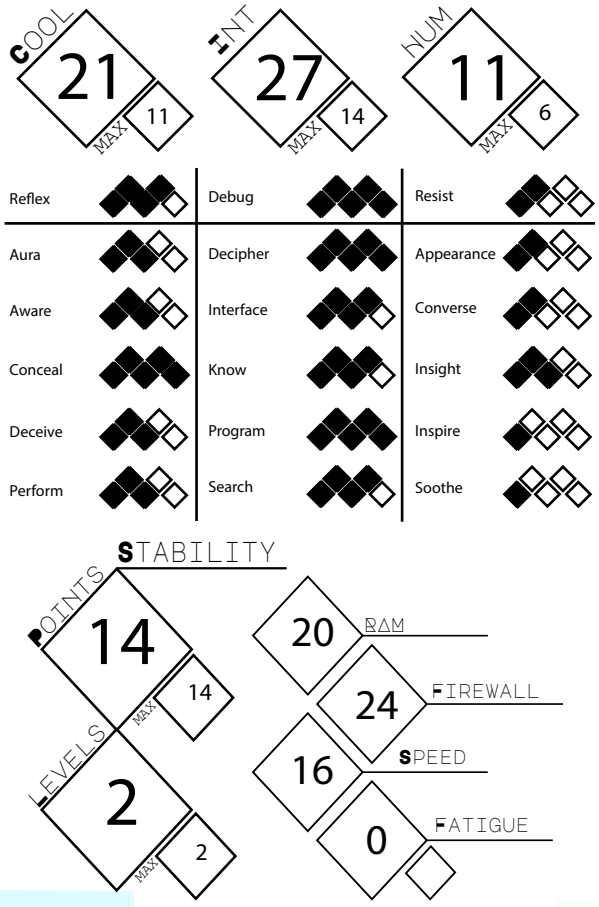
Avatar Ability:

Massive:
You're very large. Enemies can move onto and occupy spaces that you occupy. You get an additional Rank Die when making Attack Rolls with a Melee Weapon. Reduce the weight you can carry by one degree.

IO

IO is a hacker operator active within Torrent, recognized exclusively for her work for sale in The Circle, the only marketplace region that maintains recurring structural stability. No verified information exists about her origin, offline identity, or background. All records, references, and exchanges involving her use only the handle "IO," and there are no other known aliases or personal identifiers attached to her avatar. She has removed all traces of her personal history, leaving no recoverable metadata behind. IO is regarded as a systems broker and high-level infiltrator specializing in the theft of information from organizational networks, both conglomerate and Torrent factions. She specializes in slipping into secured systems, extracting specific data packets, and leaving before the intrusion is detected. This precise in-and-out method is the source of her name, and it has made her a consistent point of contact for users seeking information that is not freely available. The material she acquires ranges from encrypted correspondence and structural blueprints to internal directives, behavioral logs, and decrypted access keys. Most of these items circulate as trade stock within The Circle, where she functions as a neutral intermediary for users who avoid direct conflict with the systems she steals from. She maintains no formal affiliation with any major Torrent faction and avoids entanglement with their internal politics. This neutrality appears deliberate, as by refusing to align herself with any group, she preserves access to a wide range of targets and maintains her position as a reliable source of illicit information. Her discretion has made her a preferred contractor for groups unwilling to risk exposing themselves in direct data theft.

Stats:



Software:

Modded Arcane Staff: [RAM: 10][Boot: 0][Range: 10][Program vs. Debug]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an arcane staff, it looks more grand than its unmodded counterpart. This Software does 6 Damage.

Come and Go: [RAM: 8][Boot: 2]
Once Booted, the Entity fades from view and is now hiding. Opposing Entity must make a Firewall Save 30 DR, rolling to locate the Entity. This effect lasts until the Entity makes an Attack.

Fry: [RAM: 6][Boot: 2]
Once Booted, target Entity must make a Firewall Save DR 30 and if they fail, one of their currently active Software Crashes.

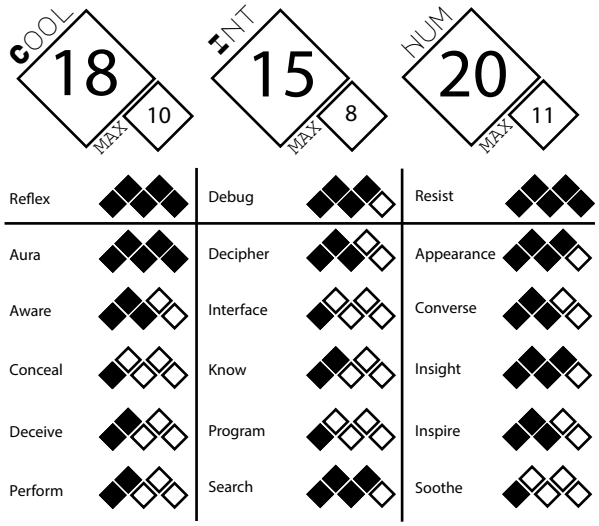
Avatar Ability:

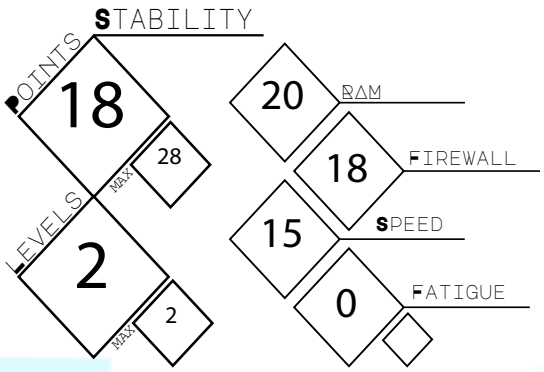
Multitasking:
Once per Physical Rest, when you Boot a Software, you can choose to Boot a copy of that Software on the same Strategic Action

Vespa

Vespa is one of the few names on Centauri Street that people say out loud only when they're absolutely certain she isn't nearby. Everyone knows she's Red Apiary, but she doesn't move like the others do, no posturing, no gang theatrics, none of that. She walks the street the way scissors slice through fabric, quiet and straight to the point, and the gang lets her do whatever she wants. Stories about how she rose through their ranks never match, but the common thread is simple: she carved out a place for herself in Red Apiary, fast enough and violently enough that no one questioned her. Most people know her by the gold stinger patch she wears on her sleeve. You see it, or rather, her, and you stop whatever you were planning to do. Her territory isn't the biggest, but it's the kind most users intentionally route around. Vespa primarily handles Red Apiary's retaliation and border work. The moments when another gang pushes too far, or someone tries to skim Nectar off the top, or an outsider digs into something they shouldn't, she intervenes. Her actions are always sudden and clean, the kind of response that teaches people not to test them a second time. Even Apiary members straighten up when she shows up; she doesn't speak, but she doesn't need to. No one really talks to Vespa. She's not the type who lingers or negotiates. She arrives, corrects the situation, and disappears. For most users, her stinger sigil is enough to turn them around, it's a boundary, a warning, and a promise all at once. And in a place like Centauri Street, where every corner hides someone selling something they shouldn't, Vespa is one of the few forces everyone agrees not to provoke.

Stats:





Software:

Custom SMG: [RAM: 8][Boot: 0] [Direct Connection 1][Reflex]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a submachine gun. This weapon does 3 Damage.

Sting:[RAM: 8][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, the next successful Attack deals 1 extra Damage. This Damage is dealt again at the start of that Entity's Turn for 5 Turns or until they pass a Firewall Save DR 23.

Indomitable: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Attack Rolls you make.

Avatar Ability:

Stubborn:
You cannot be moved from your position against your will.

Bounce

Bounce runs a detective agency in the Torrent. He works with his partner K-9 in tracking down Operators. Bounce is an Echo created by an unknown Operator, but since his creation he has joined a small community of Echos that are looking to carve out a little space of the Torrent for themselves. Bounce's adoptive father Benny created the detective agency soon before his death. Bounce took over the agency as a way to continue his father's legacy and as a way to track down the killers.

Software:

Giant Mallet: [RAM: 6][Boot: 0] [Crash Landing][Range: 2]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of a giant mallet. It does 2 Damage.

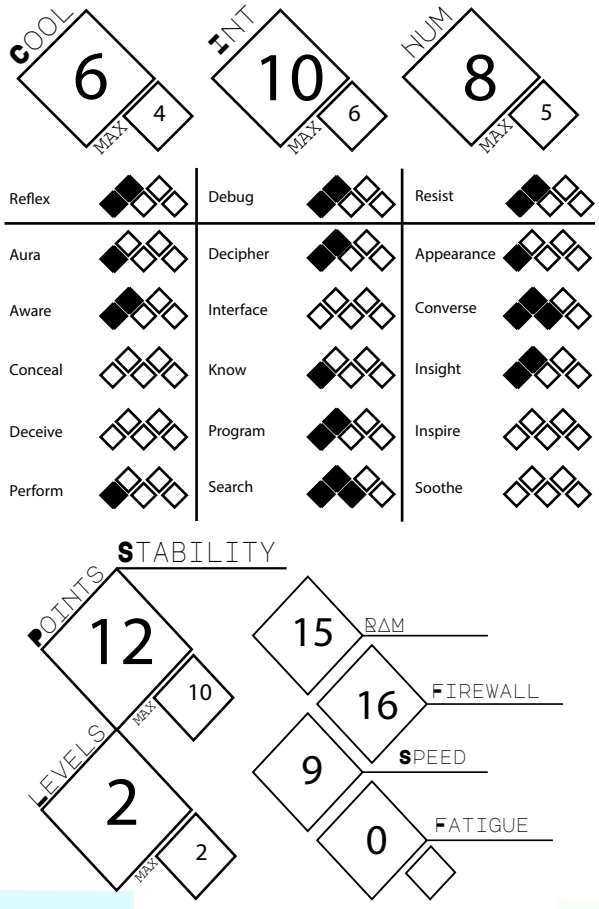
Impregnable: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Defense rolls you make.

Automap: [RAM: 4][Boot:0]
Once Booted, this Software continuously creates a detailed map of areas you travel to.

Avatar Ability:

Slinky:
When standing against a wall, your Speed is doubled.

Stats:



CaMat

CaMat is a charismatic businessman of good renown. He runs a well regarded trade shop in Centauri Street that buys and sells goods from all walks of life. His goal? Lots and lots of Torrum. He has a keen eye for authentic wares that keep his shop reputable, and employs enough muscle to keep his business the only one around. CaMat's role as the head of The Rockers is well known amongst those in the criminal side of the Torrent.

Software:

Blunderbus: [RAM: 6][Boot:0][Range: 3][Push]
Creates a Hyperstim Weapon with the appearance of an 18th-century blunderbuss. It does 2 Damage.

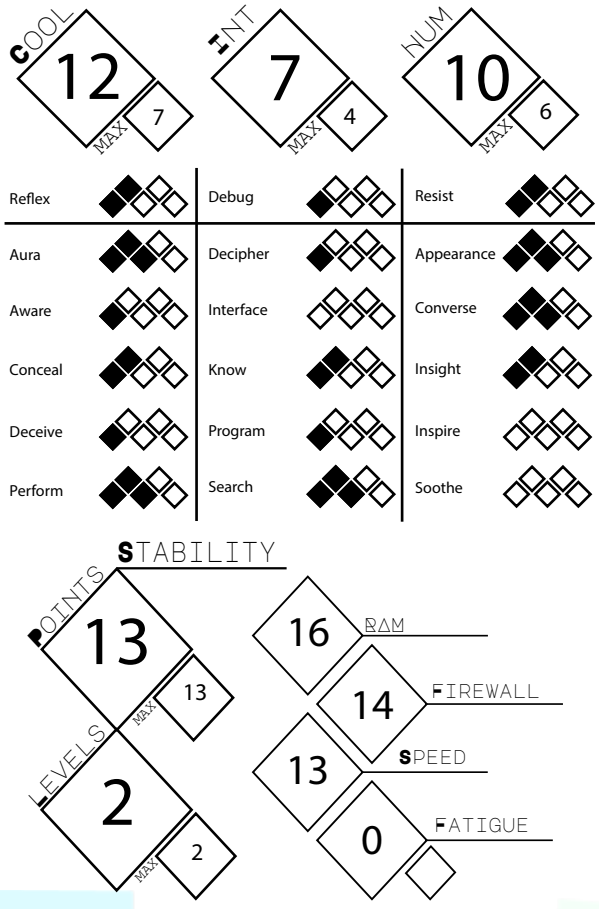
Dreadnaught: [RAM: 6][Boot: 2]
Charge forward, ignoring any movement penalties, in a straight line up to half (rounding up) of your maximum Speed. Any target you pass through takes 2 Damage.

Impregnable: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Defense Rolls you make.

Avatar Ability:

Rabbit's Foot:
Once per Digital Rest, you can reroll a Critical Faill

Stats:



DOCUMENTED DANGERS

CHAPTER 09

HOUND

These are the most common threats to runners on the net. Designed to combat human operatives in Cyberspace, these Viruses are fast and equipped with potent hyperstim attacks. They often travel in packs, thus the name, but their appearances can vary widely, although they almost always have the appearance of animalistic beasts.



Stats:

COOL	INT	NUM
7 (MAX 4)	1 (MAX 1)	0 (MAX 1)

Reflex	Debug	Resist
Aura	Decipher	Appearance
Aware	Interface	Converse
Conceal	Know	Insight
Decieve	Program	Inspire
Perform	Search	Soothe

STABILITY		
POINTS 8 (MAX 8)	RAM	6
LEVELS 1 (MAX 1)	FIREWALL	11
	SPEED	8
	FATIGUE	0

Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 3]
The next Skill Check this virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Hyperstim Jaws: [RAM:4][Boot: 0]
[Reflex vs Resist]
Slicing jaws deliver painful stimulus through STEM cables, this Hyperstim deals 1 damage.

W.△.S.P

A low threat Virus of Cyberspace, the Wandering Anti-Stability Program, or "W.A.S.P" manifest in Cyberspace as wasp-like insects. They comb through servers finding suitable spots to multiply. One W.A.S.P may not be a large threat, but left alone for too long can lead to a much larger threat.



Stats:

COOL	FINT	NUM
5 (MAX 3)	3 (MAX 2)	0 (MAX 1)

Reflex	Debug	Resist
Aura	Decipher	Appearance
Aware	Interface	Converse
Conceal	Know	Insight
Deceive	Program	Inspire
Perform	Search	Soothe

STABILITY POINTS	LEVELS	RAM	FIREWALL	SPEED	FATIGUE
10 (MAX 10)	1 (MAX 1)	12	12	8	0

Software:

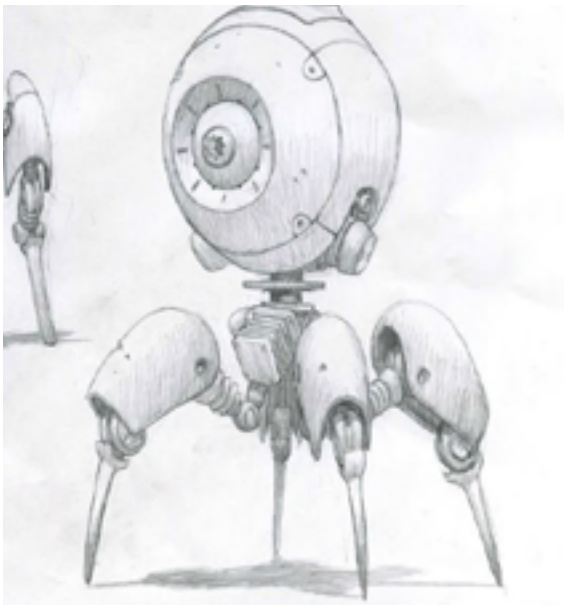
Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 3]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Hyperstim Sting: [RAM: 4] [Boot:0] [Melee][Debug]
The W.A.S.P activates its stinger, this Hyperstim does 1 Damage.

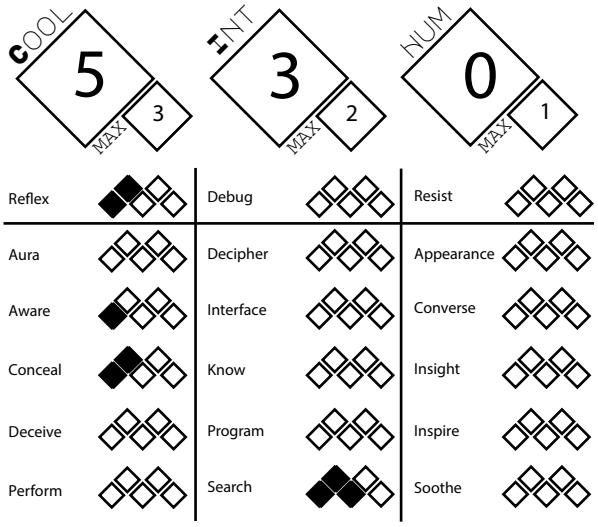
Swarm: [RAM: 8][Boot:2]
Half the W.A.S.P's Stability Points rounding up lost. Create a copy of the W.A.S.P in an Adjacent free space. This copy spawns with half of its max Stability Points rounded up.

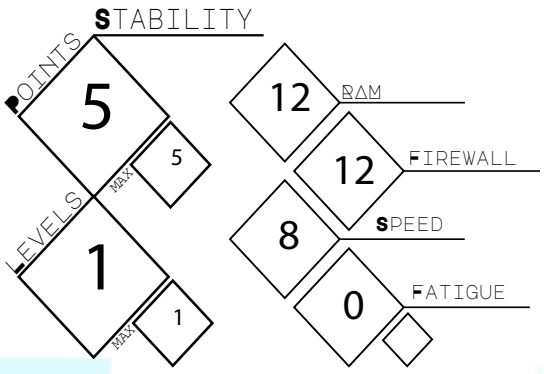
MITE

Mites are one of many low threat Viruses, mites are scavenger Viruses that feast on left over data and scraps that more advanced Viruses leave behind. Like cleaners of Cyberspace, they clean up junk data, but don't confuse them for friends—mites feed and any data presented to them, including other inhabitants of Cyberspace.



Stats:





Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 3]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Hyperstim Mandibles: [RAM: 4][Boot: 0][Melee][Reflex]
The Mite activates its mandibles, this Hyperstim does 1 Damage.

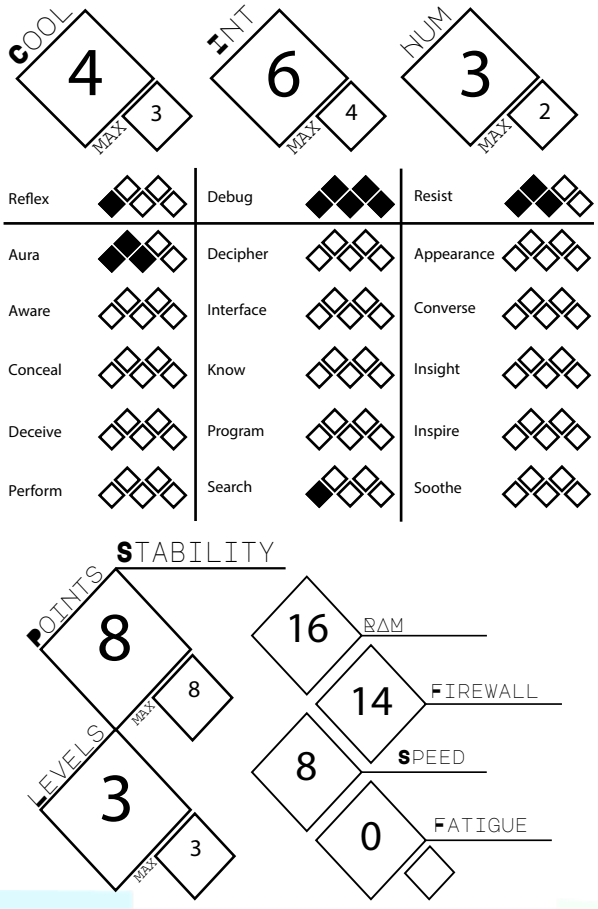
Burrow: [RAM: 8][Boot:0]
The mite burrows underground and travels up to its speed stat before emerging from the ground. The mite ignores any obstacles of height changes in the way while it is burrowing.

KRAKEN

These are rare and dangerous beasts. Designed to grind entire datacenters to a halt, they latch onto running Software and feel around for vulnerabilities. By the time crashes begin to occur, the kraken's already tangled itself in half the system-essential Software. In Cyberspace, Krakens appear to be huge masses of tendril-like appendages with a small central body. Their tendrils will feel around Cyberspace and embed themselves in system-essential programs. Karakens are some of the most feared Viruses on the net, because their talent for finding hidden vulnerabilities grants them the rare ability to make neural attacks on humans it comes across. Luckily, once they've embedded themselves in a system, they don't move much



Stats:



Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 2]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Data Tendril: [RAM: 10][Boot: 0][Resist vs. Reflex]
A tendril wraps around a target and bombards their system with information. The target is grappled. Each Turn, the grappled target takes 2 Damage

Neural Vulnerability: [RAM: 4]
Bonus: 3
The kraken's tendrils force themselves into the victim's mind, causing unbearable pain. If the target is grappled and at 10 Levels of consciousness, they must make an Intellect save or die.

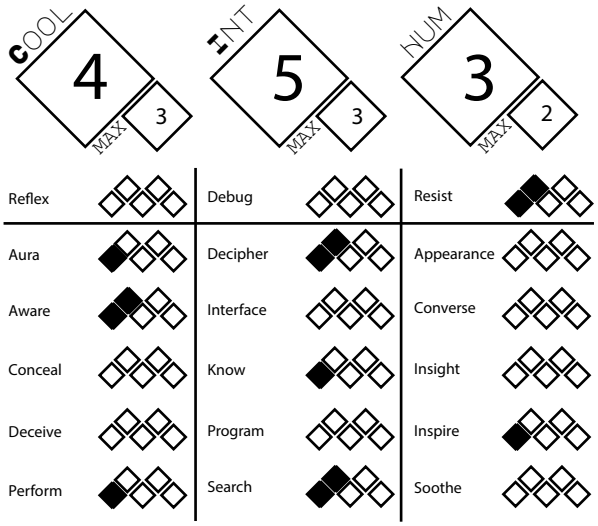
Software Disruption: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
The kraken exploits a vulnerability in a target's Software, causing it to crash. One currently-running program experiences a crash.

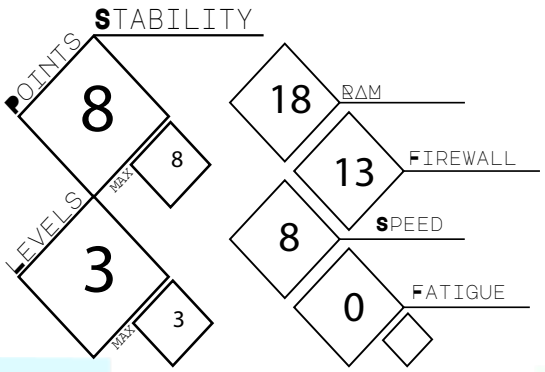
LIBERATOR

Liberators are a medium threat Virus designed to wipe and move data. They manifest in the imagery of a cross between a plane and a bird. They seek out data to destroy while relocating desirable data to safe locations for itself.



Stats:





Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 2]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Bombing Run: [RAM: 8][Boot: 1]
The Liberator flies over the battlefield in a straight line, up to its speed stat and ignores any obstacle, before stopping. It deals 3 Damage to any Entity it passes over.

Transport: [RAM: 6][Boot: 0]
[Grapple][Resist]
The Liberator grapples an Entity. It can then move the grappled Entity with it. The Entity can break free with a successful Firewall roll (DR 13) or if the Liberator lets it go.

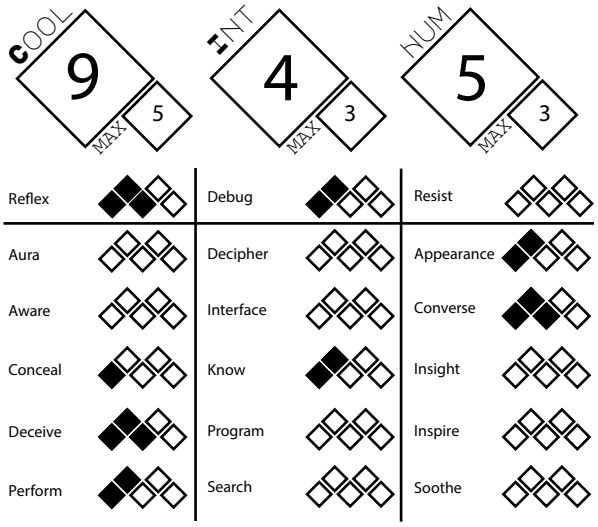
RAHHH!: [RAM: 6][Boot: 1]
The liberator lets out a war cry. This buffs all other Agents giving them +2 to their speed stat for a Turn and 2 Stability Points.

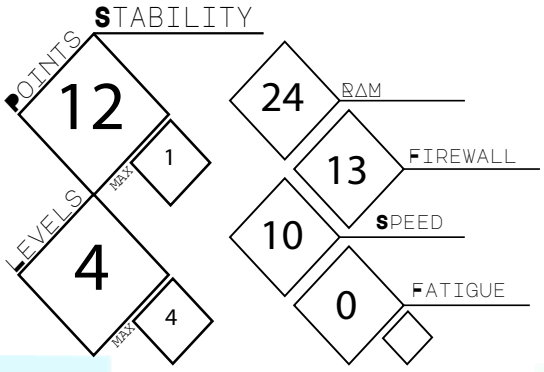
FACELESS MAN

The Faceless Man is a high threat Virus. It takes the form of a well dressed man but lacks any and all facial features, it is adept at blending into crowds of Operators and is hard to pick out except for the fact that he lacks a face. These Viruses typically find an Operator and stalks them learning their behavior and key information about them. If not dealt with, they can create a mask that allows them to make themselves indistinguishable from the Operator it has copied. Only the targeted Operator is able to see through the disguise.



Stats:





Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 2]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Hyperstim Spy Pistol: [RAM: 8] [Boot: 0][Ranged: 20][Reflex]
A Hyperstim in the form of a silenced pistol. It deals 2 Damage. After landing three hits, the next crashes a Software of the Entity hit.

Smoke Out: [RAM: 12][Boot: 2]
Centered on the Faceless Man's location, he drops a smoke bomb that creates a circle of smoke with a diameter of 6 meters. All Operators within the smoke are blinded. The smoke lasts for 3 Turns.

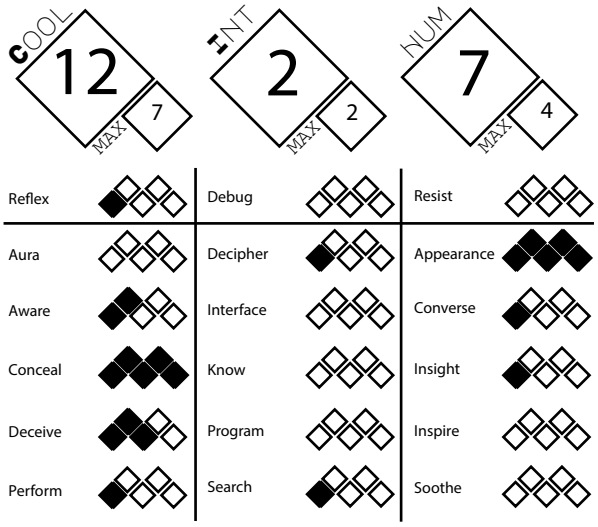
Mask Maker: [RAM: 16][Boot: 6]
The Faceless Man produces a mask out from behind him and dawns it. This mask makes him look like a copy of a chosen Operator. When interacting with the Faceless Man with the mask on, make a Firewall Insight roll DR 21. Those who fail are unable to tell the difference between the Faceless Man and the chosen Operator. The chosen Operator is immune to this deception.

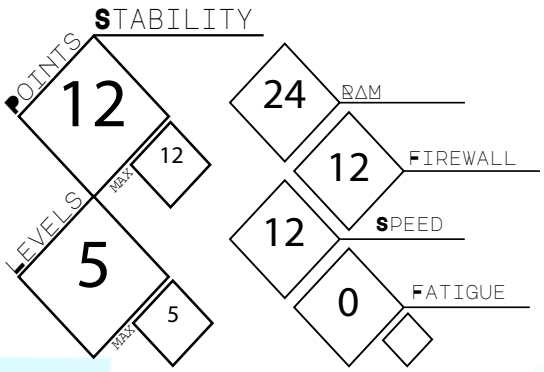
PROJECT-051

Codenamed "Geist", this Virus is a secret weapon created by RoCo during the second corporate war to silently infiltrate Datafortresses and operate within enemy territory without being detected. Its stealth capabilities are by far some of the most advanced in history. Able to completely obscure itself from security protocols and even blend in with human operatives. Its main purpose was to be a spy and assassin. It could wait in hiding until the perfect moment to strike, then wreak havoc on whatever unlucky Datacenter was its target.



Stats:





Software:

Opportunistic Attack: [RAM: 8] [Boot: 2]

The next successful attack deals double Damage, if multiple instances of this Software are active, the effect stacks.

Fry: [RAM: 2][Boot: 0][Resist]

The geist touches a target and sends a power surge through its system. The target takes 1 Damage, must make a Firewall roll DR: 14 and if they fail, one of their currently active Software crashes.

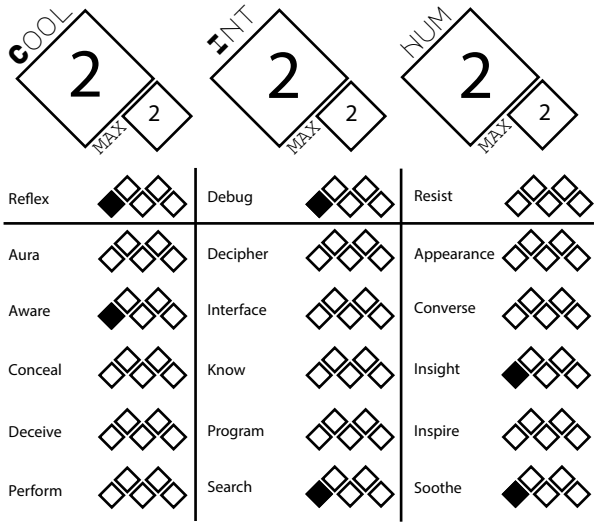
Fade: [RAM: 10][Boot: 2]

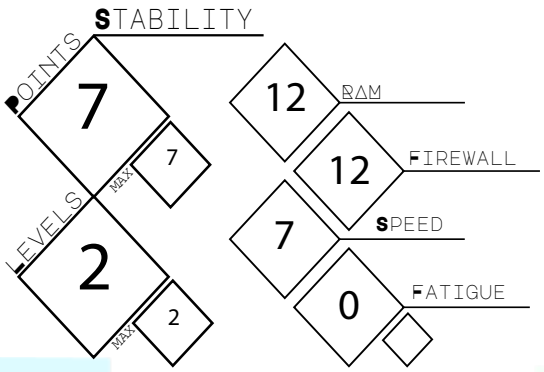
Project-051 fades from vision and gains 8 speed until the end of its Turn. All Operators within line of sight of Project-051 make a Firewall roll DR 24 or the Virus successfully hides. Operators can make an Aware roll at the start of their Turn to attempt to detect the creature. Hiding condition ends when Project-051 makes an attack.

TORRENTITES

This is a stat block for a standard inhabitant of The Torrent. These people may have small ties to criminal organizations or are freelancers working in the criminal underground.

Stats:





Software:

Revolver: [RAM: 3][Boot: 0][Ranged: 15][Reflex]
A hyperstim that takes the form of a revolver and does 3 Damage

Switchblade: [RAM:2][Boot: 0]
A hyperstim that takes the form of a switchblade. Their activation is able to be hidden if not watched. This is a close combat hyperstim that does 2 Damage.

Blind: [RAM: 8][Boot: 2]
Once Booted, this Software applies the Blind Status Effect on a target Agent.

TORRENTITE ENFORCER

Higher ranking members of criminal organizations, enforcers are the muscle of the criminal world in The Torrent. Enforcers get a rap for being "meat-heads" as they follow the orders of those ranked above them almost blindly. Do not mistake that as Enforcers as being an easy target, their rank and status has been earned.

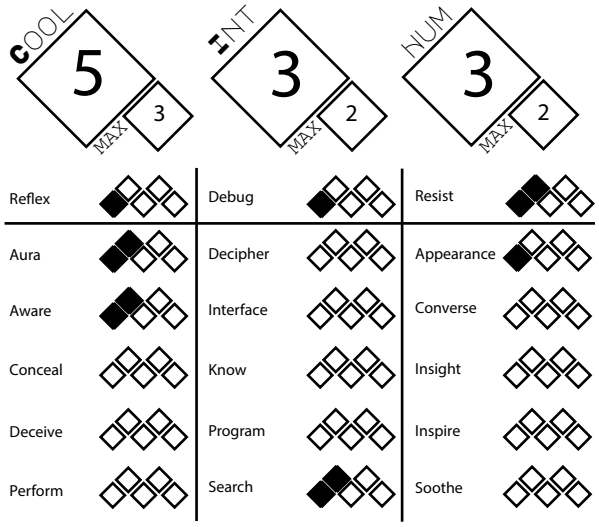
Software:

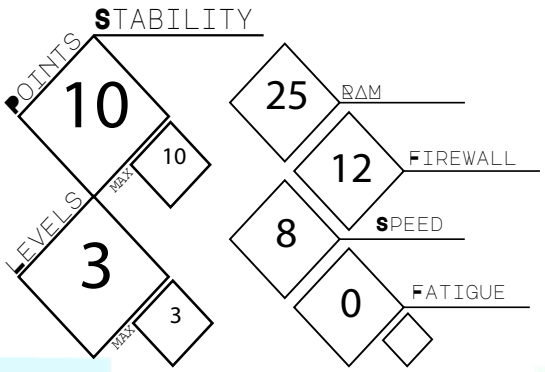
Giant Mallet: [RAM: 6][Boot: 0] [Crash Landing][Resist]
A hyperstim that takes the form of a giant mallet. It has a Range of 2 and does 2 Damage.

Impregnable: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Defense rolls they make.

Indomitable: [RAM: 4][Boot: 1]
Once Booted, this Software grants an additional Rank Die on Attack rolls they make.

Stats:





CAPITÁN

"The biggest fish goes for the head." Capitáns are the heads of crime, leading squads of Enforcers and other members of their organization. Capitáns lead, coordinate, and rally their troops to a cause.

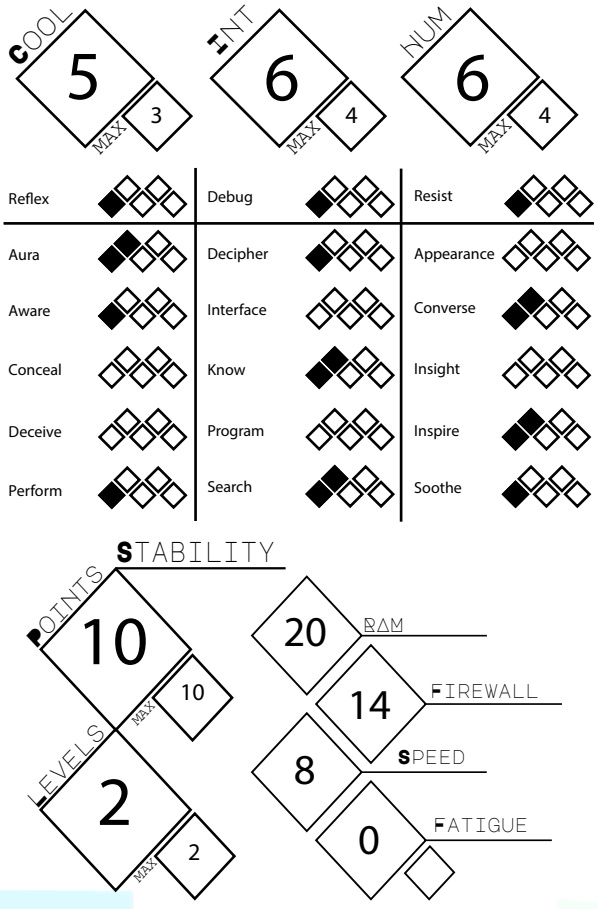
Software:

Saber: [RAM: 6][Boot: 0][Aura]
A hyperstim that takes the appearance of an officer's sword. This close combat hyperstim does 3 Damage.

Rally: [RAM: 8][Boot: 1]
Once booted, up to three target allies gain 3 speed and 3 Stability Points on their next Turn.

Combined Fire: [RAM: 6][Boot: 2]
Once booted, designate an Operator. This enemy cannot hide for 2 rounds. The DMM should make other combatants more likely to attack the designated Operator.

Stats:

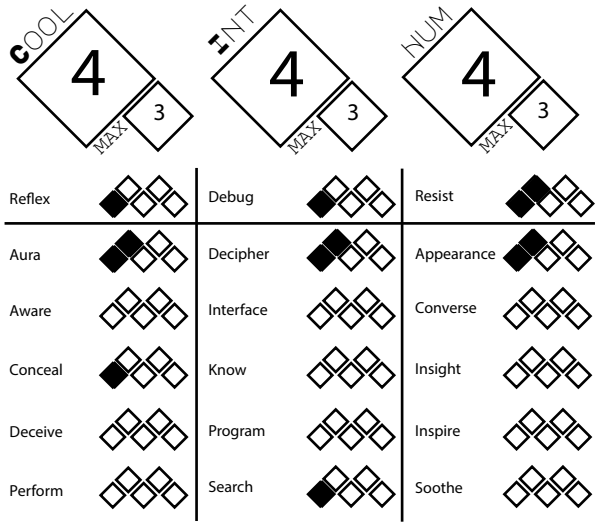


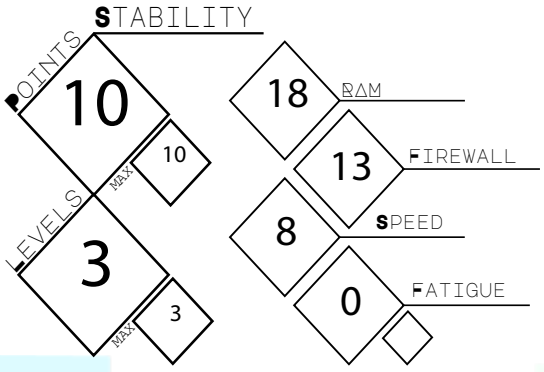
TROJAN

Trojans are medium threat Viruses that take the form of an imposing centaur. They are dressed in ancient Greek armor and wield a spear hyperstim. Trojans are quite territorial and will infiltrate their way into servers and claim space as their own. Many areas of Cyberspace have Trojans hiding where many least suspect.



Stats:





Software:

Mutate: [RAM: 4][Boot: 2]
The next Skill roll this Virus fails, it increases its rank in that Skill by 1.

Hyperstim Spear: [RAM: 6][Boot: 0] [Melee][Resist]
The Trojan activates the Hyperstim Spear, this Hyperstim does 3 Damage.

Charge!: [RAM: 8][Boot: 1]
The Trojan charges forward in a straight line, up to its speed stat or until the Trojan would hit an obstacle, dealing 2 damage to all Entities in the path.

Traitorous Gift[RAM: 12][Boot: 2]
Crash a Software of an Entity (Crashing a Software ends any effects it currently has, deactivates it if it is a Hyperstim, and increases the RAM cost to activate it again by 1)

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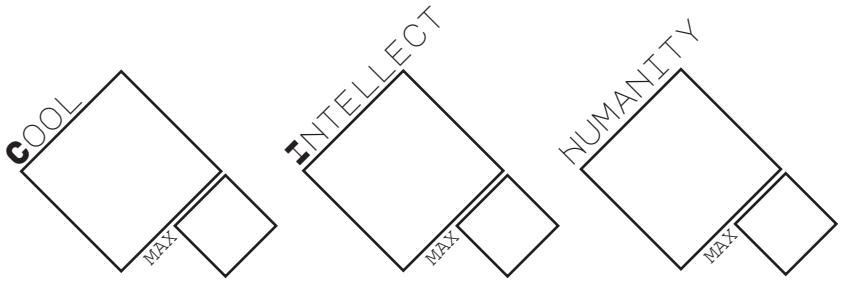
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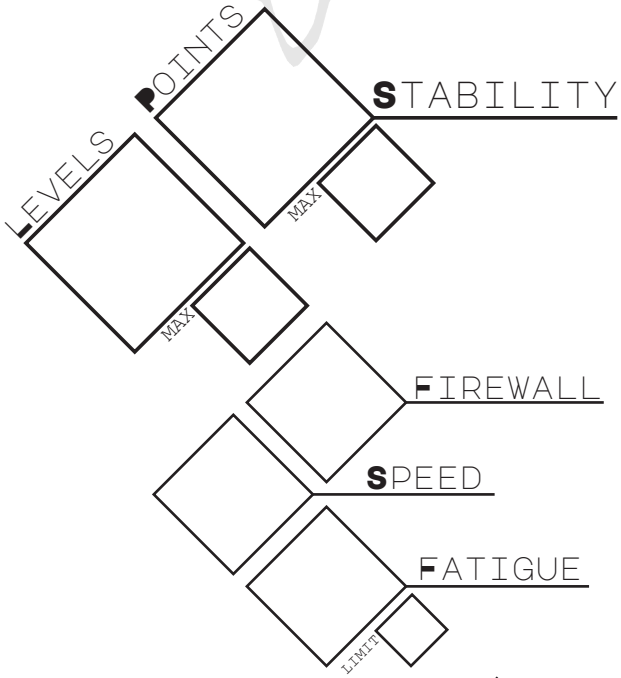
NAME

ALIAS

BACKGROUND

OCCUPATION

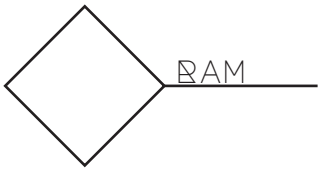




Reflex		Debug		Resist	
Aura		Decipher		Appearance	
Aware		Interface		Converse	
Conceal		Know		Insight	
Deceive		Program		Inspire	
Perform		Search		Soothe	

AVATAR

SOFTWARE

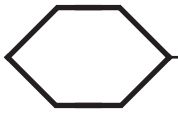


NAME BOOT RAM TYPE

HARDWARE



INVENTORY



TORRUM

BACKSTORY

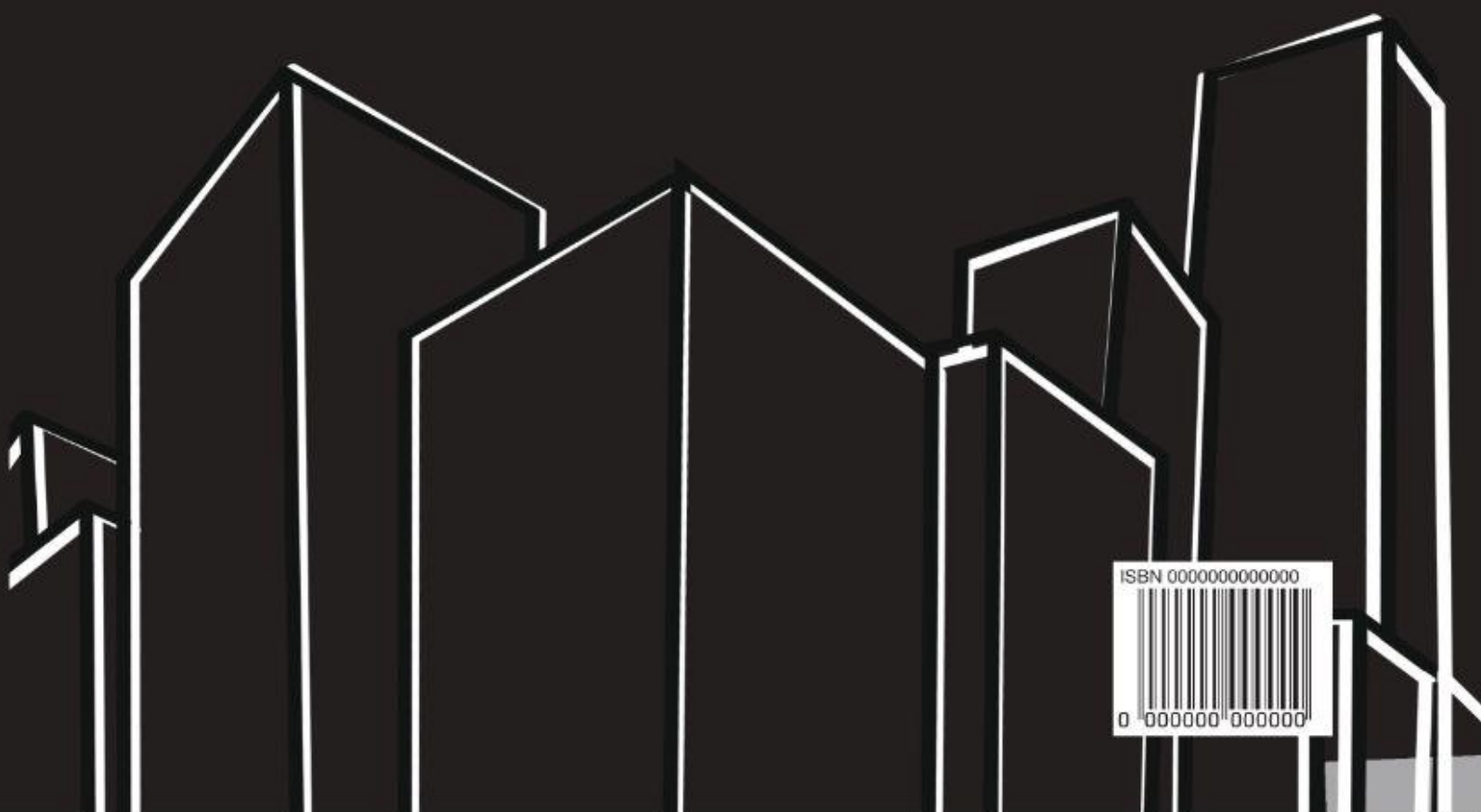
AVATAR DESCRIPTION

PERSONALITY

THE NET'S ALIVE. They'll tell you it's just hardware; an endless sea of ones and zeros, amounting to just another tool for the corporations. You know better, Operator, that's why you're here, tossing your mind across the yawning void of space on radio waves and quantum relays to reach this shared hallucination. This is a place where dreams are made, and legends are born.

The Year is 2531. Three decades ago, the Second Corporate War ravaged known space. In its wake, a new era of espionage, crime lords, and space pirates began. At the center of this new wave is the Torrent, an underground pirate city in the consensual hallucination known as Cyberspace. Away from the prying eyes of the corporate data harvesting algorithms and sheltered from the rogue viruses that stalk abandoned corners of the Net, the Torrent is a hive of criminals, pirates, and lowlives. But for many, it represents freedom and escape from a life dominated by the corporations.

You are an Operator, pushing the limits of your mind to master Cyberspace. Your digitized consciousness can go where others can't. You see the world behind the scenes and operate outside the rules of the corporations. In this shared hallucination, you can make your dreams reality. Will you chase money? Power? Freedom? That's for you to decide, but what's certain is that the Torrent is dangerous. This world will not wait, adapt or Disappear.



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